



Qualification Programme

Student Handbook



Hong Kong Institute of
Certified Public Accountants
香港會計師公會



Hong Kong's
CPA Qualification
香港會計師專業資格



Important

This Student Handbook contains information about the Hong Kong Institute of Certified Public Accountants and the operation of the Qualification Programme.

Any major changes to this Student Handbook will be communicated to you via the Institute's quarterly e-Newsletter, Prospective CPA, which highlights the Institute's news, subjects of interest to students, student activities and examination matters that affect students. You are expected to read this e-Newsletter with care as it carries important announcements.

HKICPA shall not be responsible for any non-performance of duties caused by adverse weather, an act of God, labour strike, natural disaster, governmental action or intervention, riot, or any other cause not reasonably foreseeable or beyond the reasonable control of HKICPA.

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Director's Message

Congratulations on choosing the Qualification Programme (“QP”) of the Hong Kong Institute of Certified Public Accountants (“HKICPA”) as your pathway to becoming a CPA! You have joined thousands of others on this exciting and important journey to develop the knowledge, skills and perspectives you need to succeed in your career and becoming a valued member of the Institute.

The world, with the business environment, is evolving at an unprecedented pace. The accounting profession now stands at the crossroads of innovation, ethics, and societal impact. Today’s professional accountants go beyond handling numbers. They are expected to analyse, advise, and help shape business decisions that build sustainable value. This requires adaptability, strong ethical awareness, and sound professional judgement to earn and uphold public trust.

The HKICPA QP aims at qualifying accountants with the agility required to embrace a rapidly changing environment. Throughout your QP journey, you will have numerous opportunities to deepen your technical expertise and strengthen practical skills – including critical thinking, effective communication, collaboration, and ethical decision-making. This preparation equips you to navigate real world challenges confidently, integrating knowledge and applying skills to complex business situations.

We are delighted to partner with you on your development journey.

The QP consists of three levels of designations:

- The Associate Level aims to build a solid foundation of technical accounting knowledge.
- The Professional Level aims to deepen your technical capabilities and develop enabling competencies in the workplace.
- The Capstone integrates your knowledge, skills and experiences to resolve business problems and emerge as a top tier accounting professional.

This Student Handbook contains answers to many of the questions you may have about the QP. Should you need further assistance, the Education & Training staff will be happy to help you at any stage. Please feel free to contact us on (852) 2287 7228.

May I wish you every success in your study of the QP!

Kit Wong
Director, Education & Training
Hong Kong Institute of Certified Public Accountants



Introduction

This Student Handbook is made available to every student registered under the Institute's Qualification Programme (the "QP"). It is designed to answer the queries that you may have as a newly registered student, and further questions that may arise throughout as you embark on the programme.

If there is something you wish to know about the QP, you are encouraged to make every effort to find the answer from the information set out in this Student Handbook. Nevertheless, if you cannot find the answer to your queries, please feel free to contact the Education & Training Department at (852) 2287 7228.

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1. Hong Kong Institute of Certified Public Accountants

1.1 Status

The Hong Kong Institute of Certified Public Accountants (the "Institute" or "HKICPA") is the only statutory licensing body of accountants in Hong Kong responsible for the professional training and development of certified public accountants in Hong Kong. The Institute is also the standard setter of the local accounting industry. The Institute, formerly known as the Hong Kong Society of Accountants, has a long and distinguished heritage and was incorporated by the Professional Accountants Ordinance (Chapter 50, Laws of Hong Kong) on 1 January 1973.

The Council is the governing body of the Institute and is an elected and appointed body.

1.2 Roles

The Institute is a statutory organization responsible for the registration of accountancy professionals in Hong Kong and has six key roles:

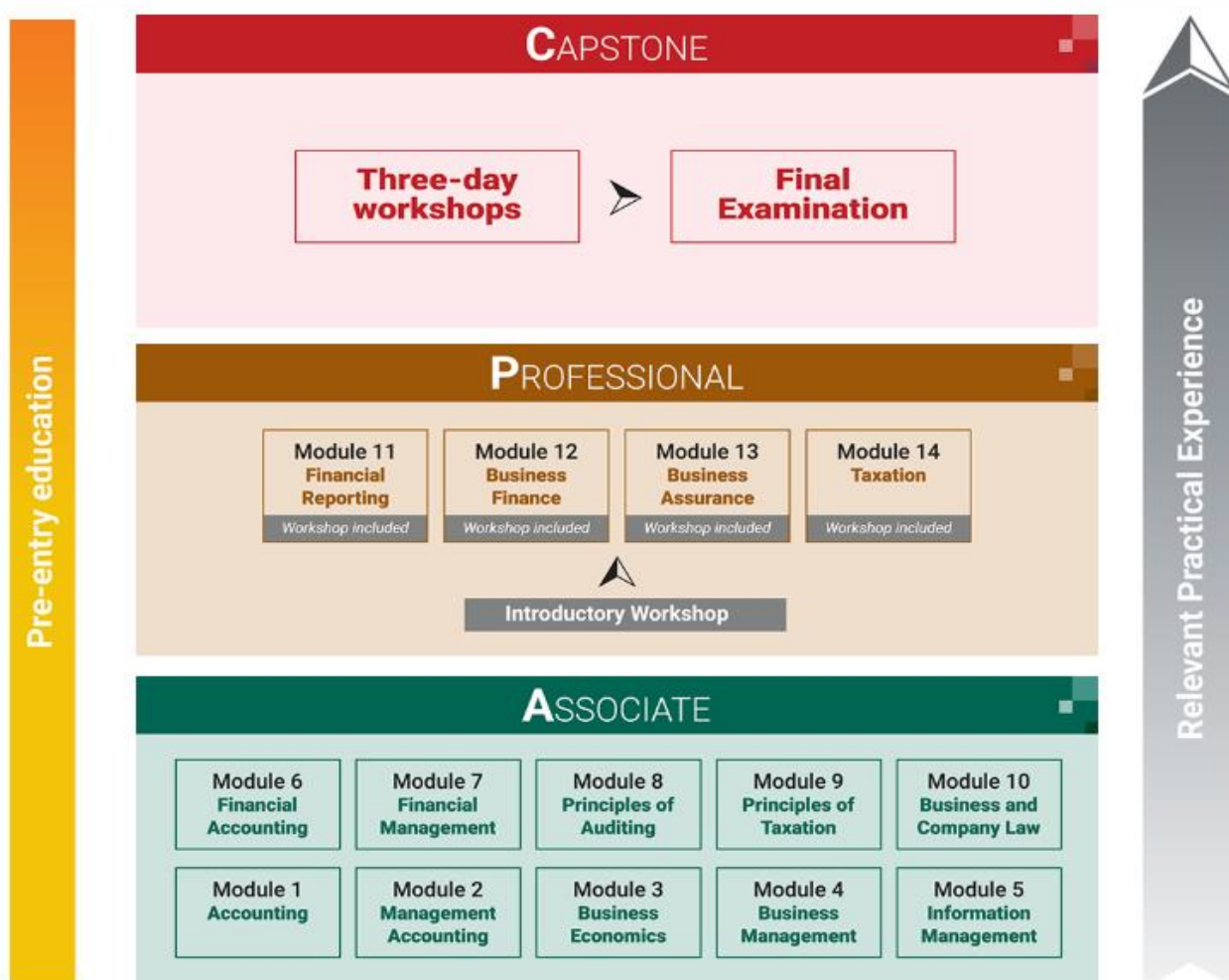
- Qualification and registration of accountants
- Standard setting
- Member support and development
- Promote best professional practices
- Upkeep the image and standing of the accountancy profession
- Safekeeping of our constitution, governance and organization

2. Qualification Programme (QP)

2.1 About the QP

The QP provides world-class and comprehensive training to ensure that upon completion, the newly qualified CPAs will be equipped with the necessary technical knowledge, professional skills, values and ethics, and relevant practical experience to meet the needs of employers in today's work environment.

The QP comprises three progressive levels with 14 modules and a Capstone, i.e. Associate Level (10 modules), Professional Level (four modules) and Capstone. It offers alternative pathways and greater flexibility for students with different educational backgrounds, including sub-degree holders and non-accounting majors, to become CPAs.



At a glance, the modules at Associate and Professional Levels and the Capstone will be offered in two sessions. Please refer to Section 4 for the completion requirement of each level.

Level	Associate* (Modules 1 – 10)	Professional (Modules 11 – 14)	Capstone (Final Examination)
Examination Sessions	Twice a year, June session and December session		
Number of Module per Exam Session	Maximum five in any order	Maximum two in <i>first attempt</i> in any order. No restriction afterwards	N/A
Number of Attempts Allowed	No restriction	No restriction	No restriction

*Associate Modules 1 to 9 will be offered once a year over two examination sessions, with four or five Associate Module Examinations per session. The Associate Module 10 will be offered in both June and December Sessions.

2.2 Associate Level

The Associate Level has 10 modules. It aims to provide students with a foundation of core technical knowledge and application skills for routine professional problems in the areas of accountancy, finance, management accounting, law and auditing to enable their progression to the Professional Level.

- (a) Module 1 – Accounting
- (b) Module 2 – Management Accounting
- (c) Module 3 – Business Economics
- (d) Module 4 – Business Management
- (e) Module 5 – Information Management
- (f) Module 6 – Financial Accounting
- (g) Module 7 – Financial Management
- (h) Module 8 – Principles of Auditing
- (i) Module 9 – Principles of Taxation
- (j) Module 10 – Business and Company Law

2.2.1 Module Examinations

Computer-based examinations (“CBEs”) are delivered in examination venues across Hong Kong and Chinese Mainland for all Associate Modules. Candidates must travel to an examination centre equipped for CBEs, where they will be supervised in-person throughout the examinations.

Candidates who will take Associate Module 10 examination in Hong Kong are required to bring their own computer devices (“BYOD”) to the examination venue.

The examination format of the 10 modules of the Associate Level are as follows:

Module		Examination Duration	Question Type	Examination Format
1	Accounting	1 hour 45 minutes	100% Multiple Choice Questions (“MCQs”)	Closed-book
2	Management Accounting	1 hour 45 minutes	100% MCQs	Closed-book
3	Business Economics	1 hour 45 minutes	100% MCQs	Closed-book
4	Business Management	1 hour 45 minutes	100% MCQs	Closed-book
5	Information Management	1 hour 45 minutes	100% MCQs	Closed-book
6	Financial Accounting	2 hours and 30 minutes	100% Objective Type Questions (“OTQs”)	Closed-book
7	Financial Management	2 hours and 30 minutes	100% OTQs	Closed-book
8	Principles of Auditing	2 hours and 30 minutes	100% OTQs	Closed-book
9	Principles of Taxation	2 hours and 30 minutes	100% OTQs	Closed-book
10	Business and Company Law	3 hours	100% Written questions	Open-book

2.2.2 Module Assessment

Upon successful completion of the Associate Level by exemption or examination, or a combination of both, students are entitled to the “HKICPA Associate Qualification”. Students will be awarded a Certificate of Completion upon submitting an application for issuance to the Institute. Eligible students can contact the Qualifications Assessment Team (students.reg@hkicpa.org.hk) for application details.

2.2.3 Module Syllabuses

For each module, there is a hierarchy of learning outcomes. Each syllabus topic area contains high-level learning outcome supported by detailed learning outcomes. There is progression in the level of learning outcomes required as students move through the professional program. For the module syllabuses, please refer to the Institute's website (Become a Hong Kong CPA > QP > Professional Accountancy Education > [Associate Level](#)).

The module syllabus will be subject to a frequent review on an annual basis in order to keep pace with the latest changes in technology and business.

2.2.4 Module Study Materials

Study materials are available online. The Suggested Reading Lists for Associate Modules will be updated on an annual basis. Students should refer to the [QP Learning Centre](#) (Members' area > Student Zone > QP Learning Centre) for review and download.

2.3 Professional Level

The Professional Level has four modules; each has a one-day workshop and an examination. It aims to equip students with the technical knowledge combined with practical skills in core areas necessary for an entry level professional accountant. This requires the development of an understanding of relevant concepts, principles and techniques, the ability to apply these in realistic professional settings and the exercise of judgment in evaluating complex issues and advising on the most appropriate treatment.

- (a) Module 11 – Financial Reporting;
- (b) Module 12 – Business Finance;
- (c) Module 13 – Business Assurance; and
- (d) Module 14 – Taxation.

The modules will have workshops supplemented with materials. The workshops will develop students' skills to research, solve and analyse problems; apply their technical knowledge in practical scenarios; learn from the experiences of their peers and workshop facilitators; gain a better understanding and further insight of learning materials through discussion in workshops; and develop enabling competences, while the module examinations test both the understanding of technical knowledge and the application of these skills and techniques.

2.3.1 Introductory Workshop and Module Workshops

There will be five workshops, one at the introduction to the Professional Level and one for each Professional Module. The aim of the Introductory Workshop is to ensure all students have a basic level of understanding for the core enabling competences. Students are required to meet the performance indicators of the

workshops. Completion of the Introductory Workshop is a pre-requisite to start the Professional Modules.

The Professional Workshops aim at developing students' core enabling competences in the technical context of the four Professional Modules. The workshops will include simulations, case studies and performance tasks. Students are required to demonstrate their achievement of the prescribed learning outcomes and meet the performance indicators of the workshops. Completion of the workshops before sitting the relevant module examinations will be the preferred sequence.

Students may refer to Section 4.2 for details of the completion requirements for workshops and **Appendix A** for details of the workshop assessment rubrics.

Each workshop is filled with interactive learning activities including case studies with workplace simulation, plenary discussions and team presentations to achieve the prescribed technical and enabling competence requirements. Professional Module workshops will include knowledge check quizzes to gauge your technical knowledge and participation. Workshops are usually conducted during Saturdays and Sundays. All activities during the workshop class will be conducted in English.

Students are expected to:

- (a) Follow their study plan and prepare well for the workshops. They need to study the module learning packs and other reference materials where appropriate, and prepare for the workshops.
- (b) **Read pre-workshop cases and complete the pre-workshop exercises before the workshops. You may not meet the performance indicators of the workshop if you fail to do so.**
- (c) Develop their technical and enabling skills through participation in group discussion and activities.
- (d) Be proactive in discussions and participate in group activities.
- (e) Observe relevant rules of the workshop (e.g. dress appropriately and be punctual for workshops).
- (f) **Keep the workshop contents confidential and should not make copies of or disclose such contents in any form to anyone outside of the workshop class, otherwise he/ she may be subjected to disciplinary actions.**

2.3.2 Module Examinations

The module examinations will be a three-hour and open-book examination. The examinations will comprise written questions, which are all compulsory.

Commencing from December 2027 session, computer-based examinations will be implemented for all Professional Modules 11 to 14.

2.3.3 Module Assessment

Completion of the Professional Level requires meeting the assessment criteria of the five workshops (one Introductory Workshop plus four module workshops), as well as passing

the examination of the four Professional Modules. No aggregate mark policy applies for workshops and examinations. Workshop and examination for each module are separately assessed.

2.3.4 Module Syllabuses

For each module, there is a hierarchy of learning outcomes. Each syllabus topic area contains high-level learning outcome supported by detailed learning outcomes. There is progression in the level of learning outcomes required as students move through the professional program. For the module syllabuses, please refer to the Institute's website (Become a Hong Kong CPA > QP > Professional Accountancy Education > [Professional Level](#)).

The module syllabus will be subject to a frequent review on an annual basis in order to keep pace with the latest changes in technology and business.

2.3.5 Module Study Materials

Online study materials, including learning pack and supplement, are available for each module. They are updated annually. Students should refer to the [QP Learning Centre](#) (Members' area > Student Zone > QP Learning Centre) for review and download.

2.4 Capstone

The Capstone aims to further develop students' ability to integrate and apply prior knowledge and skills acquired from the Associate Level and the Professional Level (such as financial reporting, business finance, auditing and taxation, etc.) and from practical experience. It will also further develop students' enabling competences. The focus is on the ability to deal competently with professional type situations, involving the integration and application of knowledge and skills from any part of the syllabus, across all fields of technical and enabling competence.

The Capstone is integrated and comprised of three full-day workshops and the Final Examination. **Full attendance of the Capstone workshops is a pre-requisite for sitting the Final Examination.**

Repeaters of Capstone have the option to complete Capstone by completing Workshops 1 and 2 via self-study, plus attending Workshop 3 and then proceeding to the Final Examination.

The Capstone provides formal verification that students who have completed the professional programme of the QP can demonstrate a required competent level of performance.

2.4.1 Capstone Workshops

The Capstone Workshops will be case-based and will require students to think laterally to identify complex problems and develop multifaceted solutions. There will also be added emphasis on the practice of ethics to enhance the higher-order skill training of the students.

The Capstone Workshops are filled with interactive learning activities including case studies with workplace simulation, plenary discussions and team presentations to achieve the prescribed technical and enabling competence requirements. Workshops are usually conducted during Saturdays and Sundays. All activities during the workshop class will be conducted in English.

Students may refer to **Appendix A** for details of the workshop assessment rubrics.

Students are expected to:

- (a) Follow their study plan and prepare well for the workshops. They need to study the module learning packs and other reference materials where appropriate, and prepare for the workshops.
- (b) **Read pre-workshop cases and complete the pre-workshop exercises before the workshops.**
- (c) Develop their technical and enabling skills through participation in group discussion and activities.
- (d) Be proactive in discussions and participate in group activities.
- (e) Observe relevant rules of the workshop (e.g. decent dress code and being punctual for workshops).
- (f) **Keep the workshop contents confidential and should not make copies of or disclose such contents in any form to anyone outside of the workshop class, otherwise he/ she may be subjected to disciplinary actions.**

2.4.2 Final Examination

The final examination will be a four-hour and open-book examination. Students are expected to integrate technical knowledge and professional skills across all areas of accounting and related fields in the analysis and solution of complex professional problems.

Commencing from December 2026 session, computer-based examinations will be implemented for Capstone final examination. Candidates who will take Capstone in Hong Kong are required to bring their own computer devices ("BYOD") to the examination venue.

2.4.3 Capstone Assessment

Completion of the Capstone level requires meeting the overall assessment of the three full-day workshop and the Final Examination / Repeater Capstone Class meeting the overall assessment of the Day 3 workshop and the Final Examination. Students who fail to achieve the overall assessment will be required to retake Capstone.

Students may refer to Section 4.3 for details of the completion requirements for Capstone.

2.4.4 Capstone Syllabus

For detailed syllabus and proficiency level of the learning outcomes, please refer to the Institute's website (Become a Hong Kong CPA > QP > Professional Accountancy Education > [Capstone](#)). All the core knowledge and skills acquired from previous Associate and Professional Modules will be assessed in conjunction with the additional syllabus as appropriate.

2.4.5 Capstone Learning Resource

Online Capstone Learning Resources are available to Capstone students. They consist both bespoke materials, reference readings and videos. Students should refer to the [QP Learning Centre](#) (Members' area > Student Zone > QP Learning Centre) for details.

3. Taking the Qualification Programme

3.1 Timetable



The exact dates for the QP timetable will be announced by the Institute well in advance of the closing dates for entry. Please refer to the Institute's website (Become a Hong Kong CPA > QP > [Timetable](#)) for updates on the timetable.

3.2 Additional Exemption on Associate Modules

Students with non-exempted Associate Module(s) upon initial student application can complete the module(s) by either:

- 1) passing the examination of the relevant Associate Module(s); or
- 2) claiming further exemption(s) after:
 - (a) the completion of the corresponding subject(s) of the Institute's accredited programmes/ conversion programmes; or
 - (b) passing the relevant papers/ modules in the examinations of the prescribed professional accountancy bodies, subject to an individual assessment (but not applicable to Module 10 exemption).

Should the students wish to claim additional exemption as described in option (b) above, only a new qualification other than those submitted in any previous applications will be accepted.

With immediate effect, a student is allowed to claim additional exemption on an Associate Module even if he/she has attempted that module.

3.3 Transitional Arrangement

Cross-credit arrangement

Students who transited from former qualification framework and have remaining modules to complete will be required to take the workshops and examinations of the corresponding Professional Modules. However, there is no need for them to attend the Introductory Workshop. If they have passed the technical workshops but not the examination of the module(s) under the former qualification framework, they will not be required to attend the workshop of the corresponding Professional Module(s) of the QP.

For students who have completed all the modules but not yet passed the Final Examination of the former qualification framework, they will be required to take Capstone of the QP.

3.4 Cross-level Examination Enrolment

Students are required to complete the Associate Level and Professional Level before entering the Capstone Level. However, students who have been granted exemption or examination or in combination for eight or more modules in the Associate Level are allowed to enroll in the remaining module(s) of the Associate Level and Professional Level at the same time.

3.5 Enrolment Procedures

Having successfully registered as a QP student, students will be eligible to enrol for the Associate Level and/ or Professional Level depending on his/ her entry academic achievements; and for the Capstone Level upon the successful completion of the Associate and Professional Levels. Enrolment information (such as enrolment deadlines) will be available from the Institute's website (Become a Hong Kong CPA > QP > [Timetable](#)).

The Institute will NOT automatically enrol a student for any examination session. It is the student's responsibility to observe the enrolment deadline and ensure that his/ her enrolment application is completed and submitted via the Student Centre (Member's area > Student Zone > [Self-service Student Centre](#)). Students should refer to the Institute's website for enrolment period of corresponding examination session (Become a Hong Kong CPA > QP > [Timetable](#)). All enrolments must be paid by credit card /WeChat Pay /Alipay HK /Alipay China. All paid fees are non-refundable, non-transferrable and non-deferrable.

Students are required to select workshop class and process the payment at the same time to complete the enrolment. Enrolment is accepted on a first-come-first-served basis and students are encouraged to plan ahead and enrol early. Completion of the Introductory Workshop is a pre-requisite to start the Professional Modules. However, students are allowed to enrol in the Introductory Workshop together with Professional Modules in the same session. In case if students cannot complete the Introductory Workshop, the enrolled Professional Modules will be withdrawn automatically with refund after deducting a HK\$500 administration fee for each enrolled module workshop or exam.

Students are advised to first attempt the module(s) where the subject matter is more closely related to their area of work at the workplace. This helps in confidence building as they will be more prepared to pass the module(s) than the others.

Students should enrol in workshops that correspond to their physical location on the day of the workshop.

3.6 Change of Workshop class

Students may apply for change of workshop class for Professional Level under the same

Module and for Capstone Workshops if students fulfill the application requirements. Applicants should indicate their preference for the workshop date that they wish to change to. In case if their preferred date cannot be arranged, the Institute will assign another workshop class subject to availability. Class change applications for workshops in Chinese Mainland may be subjected to extra VAT charge.

(a) Within enrolment period

Students can modify their selection of workshop class via the Student Centre (Member's area > Student Zone > [Self-service Student Centre](#)). No administration fee or supporting document(s) are required.

(b) After enrolment period

(i) Up to four days before the scheduled workshop

Students can apply change of workshop class **after the enrolment period up to four days before** the scheduled workshop date via the Student Centre (Member's area > Student Zone > [Self-service Student Centre](#)). An administration fee of HK\$800 per workshop will be charged for each change. No refund will be issued even if the Institute is unable to accommodate the requested change.

(ii) Within three days before the scheduled workshop

If students are aware that they cannot attend the assigned workshop **due to uncontrollable circumstances** within three days before the scheduled workshop, they should inform the Institute immediately and apply for change of workshop class **with valid supporting documents**. Late application may not be processed. An administration fee of HK\$800 will be charged per workshop. No refund will be issued even if the Institute is unable to accommodate the requested change.

(iii) Capstone Workshop

Workshop class change for Capstone are treated on a by class basis, i.e. the change of any one day of the workshop will not affect the other two days. An administration fee of HK\$800 will be charged for change of each workshop class. Other arrangements are the same as that of for the Introductory and Professional Module Workshops as stated in (b)(i) and (ii) above.

Capstone make-up class may be available for students who are absent from their enrolled class with valid reason and are unable to change to other scheduled classes. An administrative fee of HK\$800 will be charged per make-up class. The make-up class will only be available subject to minimum class size requirement and venue availability.

Capstone repeaters have the choice to either:

1. Attend the full Capstone; or
2. Attend the Capstone Repeater Class by completing self-study for Workshops 1 and 2 and attending Workshop 3 and the Final Examination.

Capstone repeaters who opted for either option is required to remain committed to that option and are not allowed to switch to the alternative option.

Students who have enrolled in the Capstone Repeater Class are limited to requesting a change to another Capstone Repeater Class. No refunds will be issued even if the Institute is unable to accommodate the requested change.

3.7 Learning Resources

Learning Resources for QP

Electronic readings for all Level are available on the QP Learning Centre ("QPLC"). No hardcopies will be provided. E-learning and pre-workshop materials will also be available on the QP Learning Centre to enrolled students.

3.8 Sitting the Workshop

3.8.1 Workshop Rules

(a) Attendance and punctuality

(i) Introductory and Professional Module Workshops

All workshops will be conducted in online format via Zoom.

(ii) Capstone Workshops

All workshops will be conducted in face-to-face format.

The actual delivery format of Capstone Workshops may subject to change. Please refer to the QPLC for latest communications on workshop arrangement.

Students are expected to be punctual for attending all workshops and are required to sign-in for both the AM and PM sessions. Failing to sign-in on time will be regarded as absent. For online classes, facilitators will call out students in the workshop to confirm the attendance.

Students are suggested to arrive at the online workshop at least 30 minutes before the start time for attendance checking. Any late arrival to or early departure from a

workshop session (i.e. AM/ PM session) **for more than 15 minutes** from the official start/ end time of the workshop will be treated as **absent**. These students will not be allowed to attend the rest of workshop and should leave the classroom/ Zoom meeting. If they refuse to do so, there will be no assessment on their participation and the incident will be reported to the Institute for review and inquiry.

If the students' late arrival to or early departure from the workshop resulting in absence was caused by unforeseeable circumstances (such as illness), students should inform the workshop facilitators and contact the Institute immediately. They may apply for a class change by submitting a request with supporting document(s) within two days from the date of absence. All requests are subject to the final decision of the Institute and the availability of the workshop classes. The Institute reserves the right to reject any applications submitted after the stated deadline and/ or without relevant supporting documents.

(b) Identification

Students should bring their identity card/ passport that they used for student registration to the workshop class for identification check. If the registered document does not display your English name, students should provide an additional ID document that contains English name as a supplemental proof. Failure to provide proof of identification that matches the Institute's records may not be allowed to attend the workshop.

For online workshop classes, workshop facilitators will perform checking of students' identities by requiring them to show their identity card or valid passport on camera. The document must clearly display the student's face and full name, which should match the Institute's records.

Students are required to name themselves under the required format or follow the instruction from facilitators when attending the online workshop(s). The format should be:

Zoom	Group – Preferred name, Full name (Student ID) e.g. A1-Mary, Chan Mei Ling (S012345)
Vevox	First Name: Group e.g. A1 Last Name: Student ID e.g. S012345

Students' workshop results may be affected if they failed to name themselves in Zoom and/or Vevox according to the above instructions.

(c) Workshop materials and handouts

Workshop materials and handouts containing additional workshop contents will be

provided to students at the workshop class. Students should keep the workshop contents confidential and should not make copies of or disclose such contents in any form to anyone outside of the workshop class. All workshop handouts should be returned to the workshop facilitators/ deleted from your electronic devices at the end of the workshop class. Students should not bring any unauthorized materials (e.g. workshop contents from other workshop classes, etc.) to the workshop class.

(d) Use of electronic devices and software application

The use of electronic devices during workshops, other than those mentioned in sections 3.8.1(e)(i) and (ii), is not allowed. Students are not allowed to use artificial intelligence (“AI”) tools to assess, analyze, or replicate workshop-related content as this would breach the confidentiality of the workshop materials. Copying and paraphrasing AI-generated content and submitting it for the prework or in-class activities of the workshop will not be considered as your original work. Any violation may result in marks penalty or other disciplinary actions.

(e) Workshop protocols

All activities during the workshop class will be conducted in English. Students should follow the instructions given by workshop facilitators, be proactive in discussion and participate in group activities, and show respect and courtesy towards each other.

Students are expected to maintain a professional demeanor in the workshop at all times. This includes showing respect for the learning environment and refraining from any activities that may disrupt the class or compromise the health and safety of others.

(i) Online Workshops:

Students must use a desktop or laptop computer with stable internet connection to participate in the workshop. Mobile devices are not permitted, as their limited functionality may hinder effective participation.

All online workshops will be conducted via Zoom. Please click [HERE](#) to review the Zoom system specifications and requirements.

For Professional Level workshops, Vevox will be used to facilitate interactive workshop activities and knowledge check quizzes. Please click [HERE](#) for the user manual to familiarise yourself with the features and functionality.

Zoom login details will be provided to students prior to the assigned workshop(s), while Vevox login details will be shared by workshop facilitators during the workshop class.

Students are required to remain connected to the designated Zoom meeting and Vevox session throughout the workshop. Any disconnection from these platforms during the workshop may disrupt participation in activities and could affect your workshop results.

It is students' responsibility to ensure their own audio and video devices are well functioned. External devices, if used, should be fully connected and tested before the workshop starts.

Students are required to attend workshop in a designated, private and secure environment without the presence of other individuals who are not enrolled in the workshop. Students should maintain an upright posture during the workshop and keep their faces visible on camera at all times. Students are not allowed to wear face masks during the workshop and should keep their microphones muted unless if they are asked to speak. Students who turned off their cameras for more than 15 minutes may be considered as absent.

Students can have 5-minute toilet break(s) if necessary. Please inform your workshop facilitators using the communication functions in Zoom to notify them in case if a toilet break is needed.

Most technical issues can be avoided by completing a system test in advance. Common technical issues relate to the lack of a stable internet connection and set-up of cameras and microphone.

Students who encounter persistent technical issues, such as disconnections or audio and video issues, that significantly affect their participation in the workshop should immediately notify their workshop facilitator for arrangements.

The workshop process may be recorded for the purpose of reviewing any irregular behaviors and performance of students. Meanwhile, students are not allowed to record the workshop or share the downloaded workshop materials (if applicable) provided by workshop facilitators. Students must destroy all workshop materials upon completion of each workshop class.

(ii) Face-to-face Workshops:

For workshops in Hong Kong, students are allowed to bring their laptops to attend the workshops to complete workshop activities. Students are responsible for their own devices' functionality and usability and should ensure their laptops/ tablets are fully charged before the workshop as the venues may not have power outlets for charging. Students should also ensure their devices' connection to the internet is turned OFF at all times during the workshop.

For Chinese Mainland workshops, the Institute will provide laptops for each group to

complete workshop activities. Students are not required to bring their own devices and must use the provided devices for workshop activities.

USB devices will be provided to students for transfer of their presentation materials to the workshop facilitators' computer for presentations. Flipchart paper will also be available if students prefer to use flipchart for presentations.

Students are not allowed to record the workshop or share the workshop materials provided by workshop facilitators in any form to anyone outside of the workshop class. All documents should be returned to the facilitators and any workshop related contents on students' own/ the Institute provided devices must be destroyed upon completion of each workshop class.

Students should follow a smart casual dress code and keep the classroom tidy and clean. Food or beverages are not allowed in the classroom. Students should not leave valuable belongings unattended.

- (f) Students should follow the above workshop rules otherwise he/ she may be subjected to disciplinary actions. Facilitators may ask students to leave the workshop if any misbehaviour affects other students in the workshop.

3.8.2 Bad Weather Arrangements for Workshops

- (a) All online workshops will continue under bad weather.

- (b) For Face-to-face Workshops in Hong Kong

For workshops that have not yet started:

Signal and Conditions	Workshops
The signal ¹ is in force or anticipated to be issued less than 2 hours before the commencement of the workshop	Cancel
The signal ¹ is lowered 2 hours or more before the commencement of the workshop	Continue

¹ The signal refers to either the hoisting of tropical cyclone warning signal no. 8 or above or the issuing of a black rainstorm signal in Hong Kong.

For workshops that have already started:

Signal and Conditions	Workshops
The black rainstorm signal is in force during the workshop	Continue
The tropical cyclone warning signal no. 8 or above is anticipated to be issued shortly during the workshop	Cancel

Students should visit the Institute's website (www.hkicpa.org.hk) for the latest announcement.

(c) For face-to-face Workshops held in Chinese Mainland

If weather conditions are doubtful (such as the possible hoisting of bad weather warnings), students should visit the Institute's website (www.hkicpa.org.hk) for the latest announcement before leaving for attending the workshop.

3.8.3 Workshop Regulations

Candidates must thoroughly read the workshop rules and details outlined in section 3.8 of this Handbook and the Important notes prior to attending the workshop. It is students' responsibility to understand and at all times adhere to the workshop regulations. Failure to follow any of the workshop regulations may result in marks penalty or disciplinary actions.

3.9 Sitting the Examination

3.9.1 Examinable Contents and Taxonomy

Examinable contents

The examinable contents are determined on 31 May each calendar year (cut-off date) which applies to the June and December sessions in the following calendar year, except where the legislations or pronouncements are considered significant and specified by the Institute and communicated to the students as examinable starting from the December session in that calendar year.

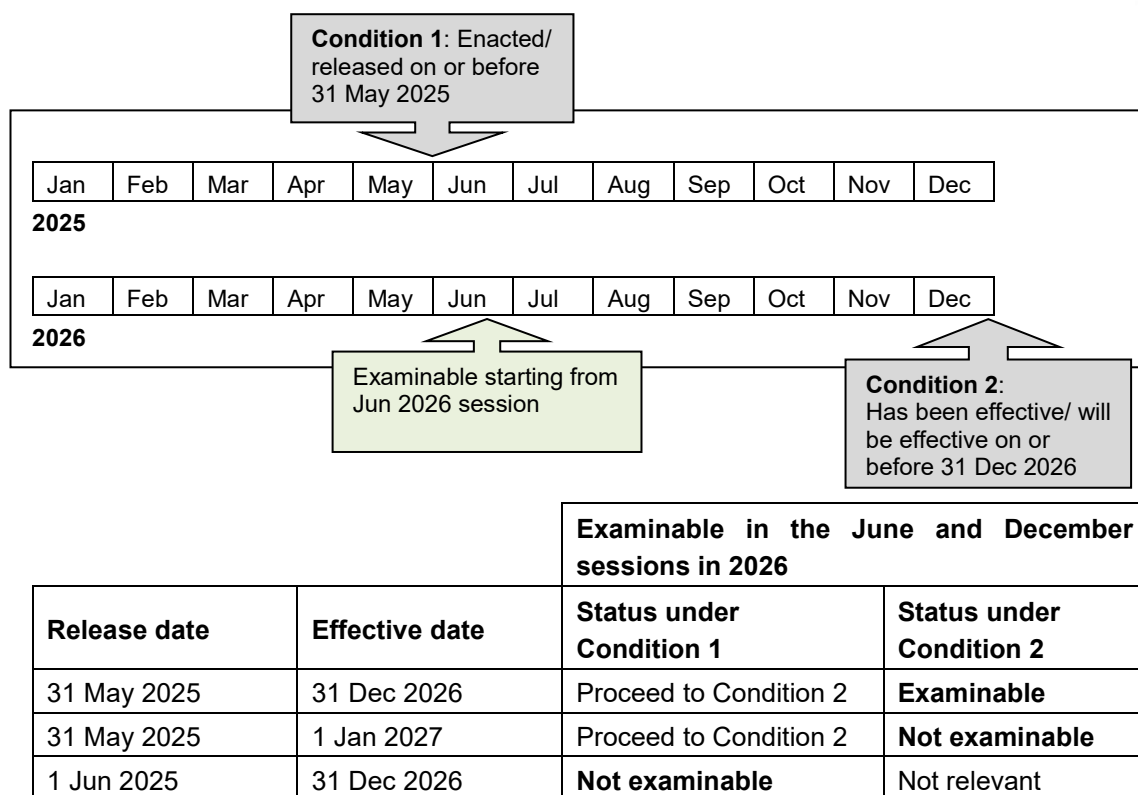
The determination of examinable contents refers to both the release date of the pronouncements (or the enactment date of the legislations) and their corresponding effective date.

Students will be examined on legislations and the Institute's pronouncements that meet the following conditions:

Condition 1: Have been released/ enacted on or before 31 May of that calendar year;

AND

Condition 2: Have been effective/ will be effective on or before the end of the following calendar year.



Taxonomy

The learning outcomes in the CPA Competence Blueprint (as contained in the QP Position Paper in Institute's website: Become a Hong Kong CPA > QP > [Position Paper](#)) have been assigned with a number to indicate the level of performance required, i.e. the proficiency level. In addition, the HKICPA taxonomy and verbs have been created to provide more details on the proficiency levels. Specifically, the verbs used in the beginning of each learning outcome reflect the expected proficiency level. The taxonomy has been used to ensure consistency across the modules within a level and a clear path of progression and articulation through the levels of the QP.

The HKICPA Taxonomy is set out in **Appendix B**.

3.9.2 Examination Attendance Docket

The examination attendance docket ("docket") will be available to download and print approximately two weeks before the examinations, via the Student Centre (Member's area > Student Zone > [Self-service Student Centre](#)).

The docket contains,

- your name and student registration number;
- an examination timetable of corresponding examination level that you are enrolled in;

- an assigned examination centre and address;
- your assigned desk number; and
- examination regulations and guidelines.

Candidates are only able to attend the examination centre and attempt the examinations which appear on your docket. Your docket serves as a personal identification and entry permit to the examination. Please notify the Education & Training Department immediately if incorrect information is found on the docket.

In addition to your docket, please bring your valid identification documentation **according to your student registration record** to the examination centre. If you are unable to prove your identity to sit the examination, your answer booklet may not be marked. You can check your **registered identification document** in the [Self-service Student Centre](#) (Member's area > Student Zone > QP Self-service Student Centre > Demographic Information > National Identification Number).

For examination held in Hong Kong:

If you have registered HKID with the Institute, bring it to the examination centre for identity verification. If you have not registered with HKID, bring your registered passport. Otherwise, bring your registered PRC ID.

For examination held in Chinese Mainland:

If you have registered PRC ID with the Institute, bring it to the examination centre for identity verification. If you have not registered with PRC ID, bring your registered passport. Otherwise, bring your registered HKID.

3.9.3 Examination Regulations

Candidates must read and follow the examination regulations printed on the docket prior to sitting the examinations. Failure to follow any of these regulations may result in marks penalty, disqualification from the entire examination session, or even subject to sanctions under the disciplinary provisions of the Professional Accountants By-laws. Candidates should read the examination regulations in **Appendix C** for details.

3.9.4 Examination Language Medium

The language medium for both the module examinations and the final examination is English. Candidates are required to answer the examination questions in English.

3.9.5 Bad Weather Arrangements for Examinations

For examination held in Hong Kong:

If weather conditions are doubtful (such as the possible hoisting of a Typhoon Signal No. 8 or above, the issue of the Black Rainstorm Warning or “Extreme Conditions” Warning), please pay attention to the radio/ television broadcast, or view the [Hong Kong Examinations and Assessment Authority](#) or [HKICPA](#) website for possible updates on the examination schedules at least two hours before leaving for the examination centre.

For examination held in Chinese Mainland:

If weather conditions are doubtful (such as the possible hoisting of bad weather warnings), please visit the [HKICPA](#) website for possible updates on the examination schedules at least two hours before leaving for the examination centre.

Please refer to a [sample bad weather notice](#) for more details.

Cancellation/ postponement of examination:

Please note that cancellation/ postponement of an examination is a very serious matter. Any decision to do so will be made only when it is absolutely necessary.

If an examination held in Hong Kong is cancelled due to bad weather, the corresponding examination held in Chinese Mainland, if any, will also be cancelled.

If the examination is cancelled in one of the Chinese Mainland location, the examinations will continue to proceed as scheduled in Hong Kong and in other unaffected Chinese Mainland locations.

Rescheduling of examinations may be arranged as conditions allow.

3.10 **Withdrawal from Examinations**

Candidates may apply for withdrawal from an enrolled examination before the designated dates. The dates of application deadline for each examination session will be specified in the application form.

For Associate and Professional Level applications submitted before the 1st deadline, the paid enrolment fees can be partially refunded after deducting HK\$500 administrative fee per module examination. For applications submitted after the 1st deadline but before the 2nd deadline, no refund will be granted. Applications submitted after the 2nd deadline will not be processed.

For Capstone Level applications submitted before the 1st deadline, paid enrolment fees can be partially refunded after deducting HK\$500 administrative fee. For applications submitted after the 1st deadline but before the 2nd deadline, paid enrolment fees can be partially refunded after deducting HK\$3,400 operational cost which covers venue rental, workshop facilitators' arrangement and other learning and administrative supports. Applications submitted after the 2nd deadline will not be processed.

To apply, submit an [application form](#) for withdrawal by email to [Professional Programme Team \(Examination\)](#) according to the application deadline.

If a candidate withdraws from an examination (with or without refund of examination enrolment fee), the enrolment will not be transferred automatically to the next examination session. Candidates must enroll in future examination sessions again as normal. If you are eligible for a refund, the paid examination enrolment fee will only be refunded to the original method of payment for enrolment.

3.11 Special Arrangements for Students with Special Needs

Students who have a disability that impairs workshop and/ or examination performance, and who require special assistance, can apply for special arrangements. Students are requested to contact Professional Programme Team ([Workshop](#) or [Examination](#)) at the time of submitting the student application or before submitting the enrolment application in each examination session, whichever is earlier. The Qualification and Examinations Board will consider each request accordingly. The Institute reserves the right to charge the cost of any special assistance/ examination arrangements provided, applicants may be deferred to the next examination session if the results of the special arrangement are not able to be released before the enrolled workshop and/or examination.

Students with special needs may be allowed to use ancillary aids (e.g. magnifiers, hearing aids). Students are requested to contact Professional Programme Team ([Workshop](#) or [Examination](#)) at the time of submitting the student application or before submitting the enrolment application in each examination, whichever is earlier.

3.12 Special Consideration for Absence from Examination

Candidates are allowed to apply for withdrawal from an enrolled examination before the designated deadlines as mentioned in Section 3.10. After the designated withdrawal deadlines, the paid examination enrolment fees are not refundable, transferable and deferrable. However, considered that occasionally difficult circumstances may arise before the examination dates which prevent a candidate from attending an examination, special consideration for absence from examination due to serious extenuating circumstances may be approved with proper and valid supporting evidence such as:

- serious medical conditions required hospitalisation which prevent the candidate from attending the examination;
- unforeseen treatment or operation of the candidate led by serious illness;
- death/bereavement of the candidate's direct family member;
- attendance for jury service or other civic responsibility; or
- other forms of significant hardship under exceptional circumstances.

The applications must be supported by proper and valid documentation such as doctor's



certificate, hospitalization certificates, death certificate, etc. Medical documentation simply stated the candidates suffered from Covid-19, influenza, headache, gastroenteritis etc, are normally not considered as sufficient evidence for serious extenuating circumstances. Applications on workload-related and/ or business trip-related grounds will not be considered. Candidates should ensure that the supporting documents are proper and valid before lodging application for special consideration. Applications without sufficient supporting documentation will not be considered.

Candidates must submit their application to [Professional Programme Team \(Examination\)](#) in written format via email within 10 working days after the examination. The Director of Education & Training will consider and approve eligible applications which are under serious extenuating circumstances. Applicants will be notified of the application outcome on the date of examination results release.

Depending on the review result, a decision will be made on granting the candidate either an “Absent” grade or a “Deferred” grade for the respective examination applied. For candidate with the “Deferred” grade granted, the examination enrolment fee will be deferred to the next examination session after charging a cost-recovering administration fee; while candidate with the “Absent” grade granted will have to enrol for the examination in future examination session.

4. Completion Requirements for Workshops and Examinations

4.1 Associate Level

4.1.1 Modules 1 to 5

The examination paper is a one-hour and 45 minutes, closed-book examination, which comprises MCQs with a total of 60 marks. Each MCQ has four answer options. There are 1-mark and 2-mark MCQs. All MCQs are compulsory.

4.1.2 Modules 6 to 9

The examination paper is a two-hour and 30 minutes, closed-book examination, which comprises OTQs with a total of 100 marks. The examinations comprise single OTQs, multiple OTQs under scenario-based question ("SBQ") and/ or OTQs under task-based simulation ("TBS").

SBQ presents a hypothetical situation and requires candidates to answer several OTQs within the same context.

TBS question involves a practical task that simulates real world scenarios, allowing candidates to demonstrate their skills and knowledge by performing specific actions or making decisions as they would in actual practice. All OTQs are compulsory.

4.1.3 Module 10

The examination paper is a three-hour, open-book examination. It comprises only essay questions, which are all compulsory.

4.2 Professional Level

4.2.1 Introductory Workshop

Successful completion of the Introductory Workshop is a pre-requisite to attempt the Professional Modules. In order to complete the Introductory Workshop, students are required to attend the entire workshop and demonstrate their successful accomplishment of the workshop objectives, demonstrate a reasonable understanding of the core enabling competences via preparation, engagement, and active participation. Student are required to fulfil all of the assessment criteria to pass the workshop. Please refer to **Appendix A** for the full details on the workshop assessment rubrics.

4.2.2 Module Workshop

Successful completion of the Module Workshops is a criterion to complete the

Professional Level. In order to complete the Workshops, students are required to complete the entire workshop for each Module and demonstrate their successful accomplishment of the workshop objectives, which is demonstration of their development in core enabling competences in technical context of each of the Professional Modules, via preparation, engagement, and active participation.

Workshop Assessment

The focus of the Workshops is on formative development of skills required for students to become successful CPAs. To ensure that they get the maximum learning and development from the Workshops, students need to fulfil a set of development indicators that are set out in the assessment rubrics for each of the Workshops. The purposes of the indicators are to encourage students to prepare for, actively participate in and be engaged in workshop activities and to achieve the learning objectives by developing core enabling competences. Students must obtain 8 out of 12 marks in order to pass the workshop. Please refer to **Appendix A** for the full details on the workshop assessment rubrics.

4.2.3 Module Examination

Modules 11 to 14 is a three-hour, open-book examination. Each examination paper comprises case type questions and essay/ short questions which are all compulsory. Case type questions comprise with sub-questions that may or may not be related. Essay/ short questions are generally viewed as an opportunity to test areas of the learning outcomes which have not been included in the case questions. The marks distribution range of each module is as follows:

Case questions	50%
Essay/ Short questions	50%
Total	100%

4.3 Capstone

4.3.1 Capstone Workshop

The Capstone is integrated and comprises three full-day workshops and the Final Examination. Successful completion and full attendance of the Capstone Workshop is a pre-requisite to sit the final examination. Completion of the Capstone requires meeting the overall assessment criteria through various assessment activities across the three full-day workshops and the Final Examination.

Workshop Assessment

Students need to fulfil a set of development indicators that are set out in the assessment rubrics for each of the workshops. During the workshops, students will be assessed

based on their preparation, individual contribution and teamwork, which contribute 20% of the overall score for the Capstone. Please refer to **Appendix A** for the full details on the workshop assessment rubrics.

4.3.2 Final Examination

The Final Examination is a 4-hour open-book examination. The examination is based on one pre-seen case study with additional information provided on the examination date and three open-ended questions. The pre-seen case study will be sent to students 5 working days prior to the examination. The Final Examination contributes 80% of the overall score of the Capstone.

4.3.3 Capstone Repeaters Class

Results from Workshop 3 and the Final Examination will account for 20% and 80%, respectively, of the final Capstone results of repeaters who opt for this option.

4.4 Examination Setting Procedures

The examination papers are set by the Institute's Examination Setting Panels established under the Institute's Qualification and Examinations Board. The examination setting process involves extensive quality assurance procedures to ensure that the timing, level of difficulty and marks allocation are appropriate for a professional examination. When these procedures have been completed, the examination papers will be submitted to the respective Module Examination Groups of the Qualification and Examinations Board for moderation and approval.

4.5 Examination Marking Procedures

The examination marking procedures are designed to ensure that marking process is consistent, accurate, and fair to all candidates. Markers are chosen based on their expertise and awareness of the realistic standard expected. In addition, the marking itself is controlled through a system of auditing to ensure that the marking scheme is applied consistently and therefore errors in the calculation of examination results are minimised.

4.6 Accessing Your Exam Results

Examination results will be available in the [Self-service Student Centre](#) (Member's area > Student Zone > QP Self-service Student Centre > Enrol > Term Information > View my grades) around 9 – 12 weeks after the date of examination.

Candidates may request ONE official transcript for free via online application within two months from the result release date. An administration fee of HK\$100 per copy is required for (i) additional copies; (ii) requests made after the two-month period; or (iii) transcript of previous sessions.

4.7 Grades and Results

Workshop, module examination and final examination results of any candidate whose performance/ mark falls within the unsatisfactory/ marginal fail band will automatically be reviewed. Results are finalised after extensive reviews have been carried out, and subsequently approved by the Qualification and Examinations Board which is the delegated body under the Institute's Council to handle all examination matters.

Results of the workshops and examinations are graded as follows:

Grade	Description	Notes
P	Pass	N/A
F	Fail	
ABS	Absent	
DEF	Deferred	
Z	Exemption	
W	Withdrawn	Scenario 1: The student has withdrawn from the enrolled workshop/ examination. Scenario 2: The student has not completed the Introductory Workshop and this grade would be shown in the enrolled Professional module.
DQF	Disqualified	Disqualification of result due to non-compliance with examination regulations.
F*	Fail*	The fail or absence grade was obtained under the previous QP structure.
AB*	Absent*	
CC	Cross Crediting	The pass grade was obtained in a workshop/ an examination under the previous QP structure and cross-credit was granted to the respective workshop/ examination of the QP.
TR	Credit Transfer	The pass grade was obtained in the relevant paper of AAT/ PBE/ JES/ Gateway Examination, and credit transfer has been granted to the respective module of the QP.
N/A	Not Applicable	The module is not applicable to the student for designated agreement entry.

The minimum passing mark reflects the difficulty of the examinations and the demonstrated competence of candidates under a series of systematic processes. It ensures fair treatment of all candidates while reflecting the knowledge and skills needed for a CPA member. It also takes care of the consistency over time and continuity in results while allowing flexibility in diverse and rapidly evolving circumstance. The Qualification and Examinations Board will approve the overall results after considering all available information relevant to these factors.

4.8 Performance Analysis Report for Examinations

Candidates of Associate and Professional Levels who fail an examination may apply for the performance analysis report. It will provide performance statistics for questions and their corresponding learning outcome to help candidates identifying their weak areas. Candidates can submit the [application form](#) within 10 working days after the examination results release date. An application fee will be charged for each examination. The performance analysis report will be provided to applicants by email within 10 working days after the application deadline.

4.9 Appeal on Examination and Workshop Results

Candidates who fail an examination/ workshop may apply for an appeal on the examination/ workshop result within five working days from the date of examination/ workshop results release. For appeal on examination, the examination answers concerned will be independently remarked and rechecked for clerical errors such as incorrect mark entries and data inconsistencies.

To apply appeal on the examination result(s), please submit the [application form](#) to Professional Programme Team ([Examination](#)) by email according to the application deadline. For the appeal on the workshop result, please contact the Professional Programme Team ([Workshop](#)) for the application details.

The appeal fees per examination/ workshop are listed below:

Level	Examination/ Workshop	Appeal Fee (December 2025 Session)	Appeal Fee (June 2026 Session)
Associate Level	Examination for Modules 1 to 5	HK\$1,050	HK\$1,100
	Examination for Modules 6 to 10	HK\$1,750	HK\$1,850
Professional Level	Examination	HK\$2,700	HK\$2,800
	Professional Workshop	HK\$2,190	HK\$2,250
	Introductory Workshop	HK\$2,380	HK\$2,450
Capstone Level (Appeal applied to the written assessments only)		HK\$8,550	HK\$8,750

The appeal outcome will be announced within 20 working days (for the Associate Module Examinations and the Capstone) and within 30 working days (for the Professional Module Examinations) after the appeal application deadline. An email notification will be sent to candidates after the appeal status is confirmed.



Candidates are encouraged to enrol in the appeal module in the coming examination session. If the appeal result is successful, i.e. the result changed from fail to pass, the enrolment fee of appeal module and the appeal application fee will be refunded.

Candidates who successfully appealed for the last outstanding module in the Professional Level are not allowed to enrol in the Capstone Level in the coming examination session. Starting the Capstone Level requires sufficient preparation time, successful candidates are only allowed to enrol in the Capstone Level in the next examination session.

5. Completion of Qualification Programme

5.1 Stage Completion Recognition

To serve as a formal recognition of your milestone achievements, you can apply for a Certificate of Completion, with a prevailing fee, upon successful completion at different stages as follows:

5.1.1 the entire Associate level (i.e. all 10 modules)

5.1.2 [the Certificate in Accounting and Business](#)

5.2 Certificate of Completion of the Entire QP

A Certificate of Completion will be awarded upon the successful completion of the entire QP (i.e. Associate Level, Professional Level and Capstone) prior to attaining membership of the Institute.

For certificate reissuance, you should submit your request in writing together with a HK\$350 administration fee.

5.3 QP Graduates

QP graduates are defined as registered students who have successfully completed the QP, but have not yet acquired the necessary practical experience to satisfy the conditions for membership.

The annual subscription for graduates is the same as that for registered students, and is due and payable on 31 January each year.

QP graduates are automatically registered on the "QP Graduate Register" which aims to establish the graduate status with the Institute as a valid and valued attainment in its own right. This register is available on the Institute's website for public access as a proper recognition of the changed status from student to graduate. In addition, the register will help to maintain the graduates' tie with the Institute as their bridge to the status of full member.

QP graduates can carry on enjoying a whole host of benefits and services (Become a Hong Kong CPA > QP Student support and benefits > [Student benefits](#)) to QP students, including access the HKICPA Practical Experience Online System for recording and tracking the development of practical experience in achieving to be a CPA. QP graduates can also enjoy additional [privileges](#) which are for full members only:

- Updates of CPA admission related information
- Participate in the activities/ events organized by the Young Members Group and the Sports and Recreation interest groups
- Professional publication discounts

5.4 **Progression to Membership of the Institute**

Upon successful completion of the three levels of the QP, students are deemed to have met the Institute's professional examination requirement for membership admission purpose and each will be awarded a certificate of completion certifying him/ her as a QP graduate (refer to Section 5.1). Subject to the fulfilment of other requirements as listed in Section 8.7, QP graduates will be eligible to apply for membership of the Institute.

6. Student Supports

6.1 Student Orientation

Every newly registered student will be invited to watch an Orientation video. The purpose of the Orientation video is to help students to understand better the requirements expected of them on the workshops, examinations and practical experience to become a CPA of the Institute. During the Orientation, students will be briefed on the module studying and examination techniques as well as the requirements for the workshops.

6.2 Student Login Account

After you have successfully registered as a QP student, your web account obtained during application stage will serve as a student login account for access the Student Zone (Members' area > [Student Zone](#)). Students can refer to the Institute's website for details of student login account (Tools > IT Support > [About login account](#)).

6.3 QP Learning Centre

The purpose of the QP Learning Centre (QPLC) is to provide online support to students, including access to module study materials, past years' examination questions and answers, examination panelists' reports, audio archive of examination support seminars, technical articles, the List of Current Hot Topics and useful links to relevant websites. Please use your Login ID and password to access the [QP Learning Centre](#) (Members' area > Student Zone > QP Learning Centre) as it is an exclusive service for QP students.

Workshop materials and the pre-workshop assignment for each relevant module will also be available on the QPLC. Students should follow the instruction in QPLC to submit the pre-work assignment in the Student Centre (Member's area > Student Zone > [Self-service Student Centre](#))

Students can view the study materials of each module by accessing the QPLC.

Students can also refer to the **Noticeboard** in the QPLC regularly for the latest update regarding workshops as well as examinations.

6.4 Pilot and Past Examination Papers

Pilot examination papers are available in the QPLC.

Past examination papers (Modules 10 to 14 and Capstone Final Examination) for the last eight sessions are available for sale at the Institute's service counter at HK\$45 per set. They can also be accessed at the QPLC.

The suggested answers are longer than what candidates are expected to give in the

examination. The purpose of the suggested answers is meant to help candidates in their revision and learning. It may not contain all the correct points and candidates should note that credits may also be awarded for valid answers which are not covered in the suggested answers.

Examination panelists' reports for each examination are available on the QPLC. Please note that the reports are a useful source of reference for preparing examination.

6.5 Module Preparation Seminars (MPS) and Examination Techniques Seminars (ETS)

The Institute will prepare a series of videos to assist students in preparing the examinations. The MPS aims at helping students to reinforce understanding on major or difficult topics of particular modules. The ETS aims at providing students with insights into study strategies setting, examination preparation, effective examination techniques and common mistakes avoidance. (Member's area > Student Zone > Seminars > [Associate Level](#) / [Professional Level](#))

6.6 List of Current Hot Topics

The List of Current Hot Topics is intended to be a supplementary reference for candidates in their preparation for the Professional Module examinations. It is important to remember that examination is designed to assess candidates' understanding of the module materials as a whole. The subject areas/ topics in the list will be integrated with other syllabus topics so candidates are exposed to practical issues faced by professional accountants in practice.

The list is NOT intended to be a list of exhaustive areas/ topics that candidates could master to pass the Professional Module Examinations. There are other areas in the syllabuses that are equally important for the examinations. Candidates should not confine their study to the list only.

Candidates can access to the list on the Notice Board of the QPLC around one month before the examination.

6.7 Condensed Revision Class (the Masterclass)

The condensed revision class (the Masterclass) aims at assisting students to cope with Professional Module Examinations. It is conducted in collaboration with training course providers (e.g. QP Course Providers), structured as a final revision class, and arranged right before the examinations. The condensed revision class may cover key items including (i) Professional Module Examination techniques and (ii) topics from the List of Current Hot Topic published by the Institute for the upcoming examination session.

Depending on the actual circumstances of each examination session, e.g. demand from students for particular modules, availability of QP Course Providers, etc., the condensed revision class may be arranged for all or selected Professional Module Examinations, with discretion from the Institute. Students can access the [HKICPA Events App](#) for enrolment of the Masterclass.

6.8 Topic-based Tutoring (TbT) Videos

The TbT Videos are designed specifically to support preparation of Associate Module Examinations. Each Associate Module has its own dedicated series of on-demand videos delivered by QP Course Providers, offering structured guidance on core and complex topics within the syllabus. Each video within the series is around 30 minutes in length to offer a flexible and manageable learning experience. Knowledge-check questions are incorporated throughout to promote reflection and reinforce understanding of key concepts.

All videos are hosted on the Institute's on-demand learning platform, enabling students to access the materials anytime and from any location. Students can access the [HKICPA Events App](#) for enrolment of the TbT Videos.

6.9 Practical Experience Online system

Students can access the [Practical Experience Online System](#) to record their practical experience attained under the supervision of the Institute's Authorized Employer or Authorized Supervisor. Students can also track the progress towards meeting the practical experience requirements for membership application. Please refer to Section 8 for more information about the practical experience requirements.

6.10 Other Services

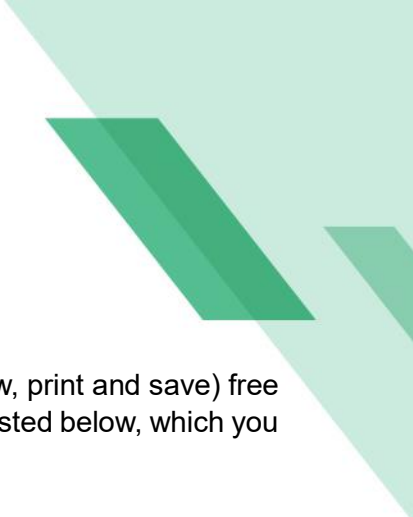
(a) Library Facilities

The Institute's Library opens from 9:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. on weekdays. The library closes on Saturday, Sundays and public holidays. Your Identification card or other identification must be shown to the library staff before you are allowed to enter the library. No books are allowed to be taken out from the library. The other rules and regulations for using the library facilities are posted at the library.

(b) The Institute's e-Journal and Students' e-Newsletter

As a registered student, you will receive the Institute's e-journal, [A Plus](#) (News > Communications > Magazines), on a quarterly basis. This e-journal helps you to keep abreast of technical updates and the Institute's activities and developments. In addition, you will also receive a quarterly e-Newsletter, the [Prospective CPA](#) (Becoming a Hong Kong CPA > QP Student support and benefits > Prospective CPA), on student matters that are of interest to you. Please pay special attention to the e-Newsletter which is devoted to matters relating to student services and promotional activities.

(c) Members' Handbook



You can assess the [Members' Handbook](#) (with functionality of view, print and save) free of charge. This Members' Handbook will cover the materials as listed below, which you will find useful in your preparation for the modules.

- (i) Volume I - Professional Accountants Ordinance & By-laws, Professional Ethics & Conduct
- (ii) Volume II - Financial Reporting Standards
- (iii) Volume III - Auditing and Assurance Standards
- (iv) Volume IV - Sustainability Disclosure Standards

7. Students' Responsibilities

7.1 Good Character and Conduct

As a registered student of the Institute, he/ she shall observe and abide by the Professional Accountants Ordinance and its By-laws, and the Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants which are in force to regulate registered students.

Students are obliged to behave themselves in good character and conduct, and to bring to the attention of the Institute details of any misconduct subsequent to registration. Students should also ensure that the information given to the Institute is true and correct to the best of their knowledge and belief. Failure to do any of the above may result in removal from the Student Register.

Improper conduct by registered students concerning qualification and examination matters will be handled by the Qualification and Examinations Board. Students may refer to the [Institute's website](#) at for details.

7.2 Fees

A registered student of the Institute is obliged to pay the current annual subscription fee and enrolment fee. Failing to pay the annual subscription fee may result in removal from the Student Register.

For students who have outstanding payment to settle, the Institute reserves the right to refuse their future application for enrolment until such outstanding payment is settled.

7.2.1 Fee Structure

The current fee schedule applicable for QP students is available for information at the Institute's website (Become a Hong Kong CPA > QP > [Fee schedule](#)). The Institute will keep students informed of any changes in fees via the Prospective CPA. The annual subscription is due and payable on 31 January each year.

7.2.2 Payment Methods and Procedures

All fees paid are non-refundable, non-transferable and non-deferrable.

(a) Payment for Annual Subscription Fee

Registered students and graduates should make payment by credit card/ WeChat Pay/ Alipay HK/ Alipay China after accessing your student account at the Student Centre (Member's area > Student Zone > [Self-service Student Centre](#)). Alternatively, the students may make payment by the following methods with the payment advice enclosed:

- (i) cash; or
- (ii) crossed cheque/ bankdraft.

The payment advice can be downloaded from the [Student Centre](#).

A payment notification for the renewal of your studentship will be sent to your registered email address in mid-December each year.

(b) General Payments

Payments other than annual subscription fee can be settled by cash, cheque, WeChatPay, AliPay HK, AliPay China, or credit card. It is, however, advised that the payments for enrolments should be settled by electronic payment.

7.3 Update Personal Data and Contact Information

Students must inform the Institute whenever your personal data have been changed or you find that the personal data we hold about you is incorrect. Records in the Student Register will be updated accordingly when the Institute receives your written notification of changes.

Students can view and amend the contact and/ or employment information via the Student Centre (Member's area > Student Zone > [Self-service Student Centre](#)).

The email address is the main channel of communication with students. Students should provide an up-to-date email address to ensure the prompt receipt of the Institute's news.

7.4 Personal Data (Privacy) Ordinance

The following explains the Institute's position in relation to the provision of personal data by an applicant who wishes to register as a student of the Institute and to enrol in the QP.

- (a) All information provided by the applicant will be used for the purposes relating to the administration of the Professional Accountants Ordinance and Professional Accountants By-laws. In addition, the Institute may use the collected data for statistical research and analysis, and for keeping students informed of its services.
- (b) The provision of personal data by means of the application is voluntary. However, insufficient information may result in rejection of an application. Such data collected may be accessed by the Institute's officers, persons or committees processing the registration, examination and related matters. The data may also be accessible by or transferred to any authorized personnel including (but not limited to) agents, contractors, consultants, or advisers performing any statutory or administrative functions on behalf of the Institute.
- (c) Unless otherwise agreed, hard copies of any documents containing the personal data



that applicant/ student provides to the Institute will become the property of the Institute and will not be returned to the applicant/ student. The Institute will destroy any documents it holds in accordance with its internal policy and applicable laws. The Institute's privacy policy and personal information collection statement can be referred to its website at: <https://www.hkicpa.org.hk/en/Tools/Privacy-policy>

7.5 Retention of examination-related personal data

Examination answer scripts and materials used for the purposes of examination marking and results processing will be retained for six months after examination results release and destroyed thereafter, subject to circumstances which may necessitate longer retention period.

8. Practical Experience for Membership

8.1 About the Practical Experience Framework

In September 2002, the Institute introduced a set of guidelines, Practical Experience Framework, governing the attainment of practical experience for HKICPA membership admission purposes. This became mandatory for all QP students on 1 January 2005.

Under the Practical Experience Framework, experience gained by students for membership admission will be recognized only if it is gained under the supervision of an Authorized Employer ("AE") or an Authorized Supervisor ("AS") accredited by the Institute. The requirements for practical experience for HKICPA membership admission are prescribed in Section 24 and By-law 41 of the Professional Accountants Ordinance.

To strengthen the effectiveness of the practical experience for membership admission and to align the process with international standards and best practices of leading accountancy bodies, the Institute launched the revised Practical Experience Framework in December 2022. The revision aims at (1) enhancing the flexibility of the time requirements to embrace the wide variety of work environments; (2) strengthening the quality assurance of the AE/ AS system; and (3) promoting communication and improving the transparency and timeliness of documentation through a newly developed bespoke online system.

8.2 Recognized Practical Experience

When an individual has successfully registered as a QP student, he/ she can begin recognizing his/ her practical experience gained under the Institute's AE/ AS from the commencement date of the Practical Experience Period.

QP students should inform their current employer or supervisor, who is an AE or AS, of their needs to acquire practical experience. Once your current employer or supervisor update your information and it is approved by the Institute, you will be granted access to start your [practical experience process](#).

It is the student's responsibility to ensure that he/ she acquires the appropriate type and level of practical experience under the supervision of the Institute's AE or AS. Students are required to attain a combination of time requirements (input based), and technical and enabling competence requirements (output based) in their workplace.

Within the required length of practical experience for membership, a student is allowed a maximum of three employments and only one of the employments can be less than 12 months. The rest of the experience must be acquired from employment(s) that lasts for at least 12 months with the same employer. Depending on the academic qualifications of the student, the respective requirements are:

	Minimum length of relevant practical experience	Minimum Working Days during the total Practical Experience Period
Approved degree holders, or students graduated from the Associate Level of the QP	3 years	500 Working Days
Approved accountancy diploma holders	4 years	670 Working Days
Holders of other academic qualifications	5 years	830 Working Days

Students are required to complete a minimum of 500, 670 and 830 Working Days within the three, four and five years of Practical Experience Period, respectively.

To ensure relevancy of practical experience, the practical experience of a student must be attained within 10 years prior to the date of the student applying for HKICPA membership (10-year Recency Rule). In other words, practical experience which is not acquired within 10 years prior to the date of HKICPA membership application will not be recognized.

All requirements for recognized practical experience are detailed in Section 2 of the [Support Manual for the revised Practical Experience Framework](#) (the "Support Manual") (Become a Hong Kong CPA > QP > [Revised Practical Experience Framework](#)).

8.3 Documentation for Recording Practical Experience

8.3.1 Development Commitment

To ensure that both students and AE/ AS have a clear understanding of the expectations and responsibilities on practical experience training, students should initiate to create a Development Commitment through the Practical Experience Online System for the AE/ AS to review and sign within three months upon commencement of the Practical Experience Period.

Failure to sign and submit the Development Commitment online implies that the practical experience acquired by the student may not be recognized, and the student's admission to HKICPA membership will be delayed.

Once the Development Commitment is approved, the student can create his/her Training Records for recording the recognized practical experience.

Should the Development Commitment be terminated for any reasons, the student is required to inform the Institute immediately. In addition, whenever the student resumes practical experience training, he/ she should enter into a Development Commitment with the new AE/ AS.

8.3.2 Training Records

The [Practical Experience Competence Grid](#) as contained in the Support Manual specifies the knowledge and skills that students need to possess in order to satisfy the Institute's practical experience requirements.

Students are required to record the recognized practical experience in the Training Records through the Practical Experience Online System.

Interim and annual review meetings should be conducted for each training year. Students are required to complete and submit the Training Records and supporting evidence (e.g. timesheets, performance appraisal forms, work samples, etc.) to their AE-Counselor or AS for review and sign-off at least on an annual basis (by 31 December each year, or according to their specific appraisal or review date). Failure to conduct the annual sign-off of the Training Records without reasonable cause may result in rejection of the students' membership application.

Through the online system, you can also generate a Training Records Summary which provides you with a brief summary of your practical experience and highlights any requirements that may not fully achieved.

At the completion of the Practical Experience Period or when the Development Commitment is terminated for any reasons (e.g. QP student is no longer an employee of the AE or AS employing organization), students should submit the signed-off Training Records for final sign-off (i.e. the AE Member-In-Charge/ AS's endorsement) to confirm the students' attained competences and their employment period.

In case of termination of the Development Commitment, the Training Records should be endorsed by the AE Member-In-Charge/ AS within three months of the end date of Practical Experience Period.

8.3.3 Change of Employment

If a student changes employment during the Practical Experience Period, he/ she must inform his/ her Counselor/ AS and the Institute about the change. Before the student departs, he/ she should complete the Training Records and obtain final sign-off from the AE/ AS on the Training Records for the supervision period.

In the event that the student may have to continue to attain the remaining practical experience under supervision of a new Counselor/ AS, he/ she and the new AE/ AS will sign a new Development Commitment, and the student will attain the remaining required practical experience and record them under a new set of Training Records.

For more information of the practical experience process, please refer to [Overview for QP students – Record for practical experience](#), and Section 5 of the [Support Manual](#).

8.4 Recognition of practical experience obtained under the legacy Practical Experience Framework

The revised Practical Experience Framework has been implemented on 1 January 2023. QP students who have started accumulating experience **prior to 1 January 2023** ("transitioning student") were allowed to attain the practical experience under the legacy Practical Experience Framework **until 31 December 2025**.

All QP students are required to acquire their practical experience under the revised Practical Experience Framework **on or after 1 January 2026** if that part of experience is to be counted for the Institute's membership admission purpose. The required supporting documents are listed below:

- Duly signed Training Records by an AE-Counselor or AS, covering the practical experience period under both the legacy and revised PE Framework; and
- A completed Conversion Report to ensure the practical experience gained under the legacy PE Framework meets the revised PE Framework requirements, or if there are any shortfalls.

For more information, please refer to the [factsheet](#) or the Institute's [website](#) to obtain all essential information.

8.5 Applying for CPA Membership

When students have completed the Capstone and gained sufficient practical experience under AE/ AS, they can apply for membership with the Institute. Students should submit the online membership application form with other required documents, including the signed summary report of the Training Records. For further details, please obtain from the Membership & Admission Department of the Institute or visit the Institute's website (Membership > Registration > [Register as a CPA](#)).

8.6 Designation of Members

A member is designated as a Certified Public Accountant ("CPA") and entitled to use the following initials for his/her appropriate status in the Institute:

- | | | |
|--------|---|--|
| Member | – | CPA |
| Fellow | – | F CPA (seven years' standing with the Institute) |

8.7 Membership Admission

To become a member of the Institute, an applicant has to satisfy the following requirements:

- (a) have completed the QP;
- (b) have acquired relevant practical experience with the AE/ AS complying with the Practical

- Experience Framework;
- (c) be of good character and be a fit and proper person to be a CPA; and
 - (d) have attained the age of 21.

8.8 International Recognition

8.8.1 Bilateral Overseas Recognition Agreements

To date, the Institute has entered into several bilateral recognition agreements with the leading overseas accountancy professional bodies, which include the following:

- (a) Reciprocal Membership Agreements
 - Chartered Accountants Australia and New Zealand (CA ANZ)
 - Chartered Accountants Ireland (CAI)
 - Chartered Professional Accountants Canada (CPA Canada)
 - Institute of Chartered Accountants in England and Wales (ICAEW)
 - Institute of Chartered Accountants of Scotland (ICAS)
 - Institute of Chartered Accountants of Zimbabwe (ICAZ)
 - South African Institute of Chartered Accountants (SAICA)
- (b) Mutual Recognition Agreement
 - Association of Chartered Certified Accountants (ACCA)
 - CPA Australia (CPAA)

These agreements will enable our members who have completed the QP in full and worked under an AE/ AS or equivalent to become their members. Students who are interested in knowing more about these agreements and the QP international recognition status with other overseas accountancy professional bodies may refer to the Institute's website (Membership > Registration > Register as a CPA > [Recognition of overseas bodies](#)).

8.8.2 Mutual Examination Paper Exemptions

The Institute has also entered into bilateral agreements with other leading accounting bodies on mutual examination paper exemptions, which include the following:

- Chartered Institute of Management Accountants (CIMA)
- Chinese Institute of Certified Public Accountants (CICPA)

8.9 Practising Certificate

It is important to note that only holders of a Practising Certificate ("PC") issued by the Accounting and Financial Reporting Council ("AFRC") are allowed to perform statutory audits in Hong Kong. A PC holder may be described as a CPA (Practising). For full details of the practising certificate issuance requirements, please refer to the AFRC's website.

9. Resignation/ Removal from Student Register/ Re-registration

9.1 Student Resignation

If you wish, for any reason, to resign from the Student Register, you should notify the Institute with a completed "Discontinuation of Studentship" form (obtained from Qualifications Assessment Team by email – students.reg@hkicpa.org.hk).

9.2 Removal from Student Register

9.2.1 Incomplete Student Renewal

All registered students are required to renew their studentship annually no later than 31 January. The renewal process entails the following:

- (i) Completion of the annual declaration form
- (ii) Payment of the annual registration fee

If the annual declaration form is not completed and the annual registration fee is in arrears for more than three months, it will result in the removal of your name from the Student Register. Consequently, you will no longer have access to the Practical Experience Online System and your online Training Records.

9.2.2 Time Limits

In accordance with By-law 39(1) of the Professional Accountants Ordinance, the Registrar shall remove from the register the name of any registered student who has not presented himself for any of the examinations of the Institute within 5 years or those who have not passed the final section of the examinations of the Institute within 10 years from the date of his registration as a registered student.

The Institute's Qualification and Examinations Board stipulates that the time limit rule must be administered rigorously and only students with exceptional circumstances could be granted extension under the By-law 39(2). That is, those who have reached the time limit will be removed from the student register and will be required to start the QP afresh.

Students can access their student account at the Institute's website to enquire their date of student registration.

The Registrar shall remove your name from the Student Register if you:

- (a) have not presented yourself for any of the examinations within five years of registration (By-law 39(1)(a)); or
- (b) have not passed the final section of the examinations of the Institute within 10

years from the date of his registration as a registered student (By-law 39(1)(b)).

For those who have not completed the QP within ten years from the date of student registration, the passes that they have obtained in the modules previously taken will lapse and their current student registration number will be invalid. They will be required to start afresh and re-register their studentship with the Institute should they wish to continue their study of the QP. For the module exemptions previously granted, they can only be retained provided that the students register again as a QP student within two years from the date of removal.

9.2.3 Misconduct

Your name may also be removed on disciplinary grounds. Students are required to observe and abide by the Professional Accountants Ordinance, Professional Accountants Ordinance By-laws and the Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants which are in force to regulate registered students. These rules are contained in the Institute's Members' Handbook Volume I, available in the Institute's library at 27th floor of Wu Chung House, Wanchai, Hong Kong. You can also look them up in the Institute's website (Membership > [Members' Handbook](#)). Further details on removal are given in an extract of the Professional Accountants By-laws in **Appendix D**.

9.3 Re-registration

Students may apply for re-registration at a fee, but their application will be considered in accordance with the rules prevailing at the time of re-registration.

For students who are removed from the Student Register for non-payment of annual subscription or for any other reason such as disciplinary action, when they subsequently re-register, they are required to pay the re-registration fee and the annual subscription fee.

For students who resign and subsequently re-register with the Institute, their initial student registration number will be given and their registration date will be the same as the initial registration date, that is, they are subject to the 5-year/ 10-year time bar rule as specified under Professional Accountants By-law 39(1) from the initial registration date. If they have successfully completed a module, they will be credited with that module passed subject to the ten-year time limit.

Appendix A: Workshop Assessment Rubrics

Introductory Workshop

Passing requirement: 100% (three green lights). This is a prerequisite to professional modules.

Assessment Criteria	Performance Indicators	Meet – Green Light (1 mark)	Fail – Red light (0 mark)
Level of engagement/ participation	The participant is engaged in the activities and with one another.	Participant is actively engaged and showed willingness to take up roles in the group.	Participant refused to take part in any of the activities.
Preparation	The participant has completed the pre-work and is well prepared <u>before</u> the workshop.	Participant has completed all pre-work assignments.	Participant has not done the pre-work assignments.
Attitude and behavior	The participant has worked well with team members, respected facilitators, adhered to an ethical mindset and exhibits professionalism.	Participant exhibited professional behavior during the workshop.	Participants did not exhibit professional behavior on several occasions during the workshop.

Professional Modules Workshop (Module 11 – 14)

Passing requirement: 8 out of 12 marks

Assessment Criteria	Performance Indicators	Exceed (2 marks)	Meet (1 mark)	Fail (0 mark)
Demonstration of analytical skills	The participant has developed analytical skills.	Participant demonstrates a reasonable level of analytical skills in performing workshop activities.	Participant demonstrates progress in developing analytical skills in performing workshop activities.	Participant does not demonstrate any analytical skills during the day of workshop.
Demonstration of problem-solving skills	The participant has developed problem-solving skills.	Participant demonstrates the application of the problem-solving process during the day of workshop.	Participant demonstrates progress in developing problem-solving skills during the day of workshop.	Participant does not demonstrate any problem-solving skills during the day of workshop.
Demonstration of communication skills	The participant has developed communication skills.	Participant demonstrates the Three Pillars of Communications, Written and Presentation guidelines during the day of workshop.	Participant demonstrates progress in developing communication skills according to the Three Pillars of Communications, Written and Presentation guidelines during the day of workshop.	Participant does not demonstrate any communication skills during the day of workshop.
Preparation	The participant has completed the pre-work and is well prepared before the workshop	N/A	Participant has completed all pre-work assignments and demonstrates an understanding of the prework during the workshop.	Participant has completed some or none of the pre-work assignments, <u>or</u> does not demonstrate an understanding of the prework during the workshop activities.

Assessment Criteria	Performance Indicators	Exceed (2 marks)	Meet (1 mark)	Fail (0 mark)
Level of engagement/ participation	The participant is engaged/ has participated in the activities and with one another.	Participant is engaged in the activities and with one another contributes to discussions, <u>and</u> completes the most of the in-class challenge quizzes.	Participant participates in the activities, works with one another, contributes to discussions, <u>and</u> completes some of the in-class challenge quizzes.	Participant participates in very few or none of the activities, does not work with one another <u>and/ or fails</u> to complete at least some of the in-class challenge quizzes.
Demonstration of technical competences	The participant has demonstrated the technical skills required for learning activity.	Participant demonstrates a reasonable level of knowledge on the technical content being covered during the workshop activities <u>and</u> correctly answers most of the in-class challenge quizzes.	Participant demonstrates a progress in developing an understanding of the technical content being covered during the workshop activities <u>and</u> correctly answers some of the in-class challenge quizzes.	Participant demonstrates very little or no understanding of the technical content being covered during the workshop <u>and/ or</u> fails to correctly answer at least some of the in-class challenge quizzes.
Attitude and behaviour	The participant has worked well with team members, respects facilitators, adheres to an ethical mindset and exhibits professionalism.	N/A	Participant exhibits professional and ethical behaviour during the workshop.	Participant exhibits unprofessional and/or unethical behaviour during the workshop.

Capstone Workshop

Individual Contribution - Day 1 (5%)/ Day 2 (5%)

Assessment Area			Exceed (2 marks)	Meet (1 mark)	Below Standard (0 mark)	Weighting
(Interval marks, i.e. 0.5 and 1.5, are allowed for <u>all</u> Assessment Areas, except Preparation, where students will be marked 0, 1, 1.5 or 2 depending on their pre-work completion and quality of work.)						
1	Preparation	The participant completed all Pework and was well prepared <u>before</u> the Workshop.	Participant completed all Pework assignments demonstrating the knowledge required.	Participant completed all Pework assignments.	Participant completed some or none of the Pework assignments.	2%
2	Level of engagement/ Participation	The participant was engaged in the activities and with one another.	Participant was actively engaged in all activities and with team members, consistently contributed to large group and team discussions of the day.	Participant was engaged in the activities and with team members, contributed to large group and team discussions of the day most of the time.	Participant was disengaged in the activities and with team members, did not/seldom contribute to large group and team discussions of the day.	1%
3	Demonstration of Core Enabling Competences	The participant demonstrated their competences in CECs, including the analytical skills, problem solving skills, communication skills and/or ethical dilemma, required for the Workshop activities.	Participant consistently demonstrated the analytical skills, problem solving skills and/ or communication skills in performing all Workshop activities.	Participant demonstrated reasonable level of analytical skills, problem solving skills and communication skills in performing most of Workshop activities.	Participant did not/ seldom demonstrate analytical skills, problem solving skills and communication skills in performing Workshop activities.	1%

Assessment Area			Exceed (2 marks)	Meet (1 mark)	Below Standard (0 mark)	Weighting
(Interval marks, i.e. 0.5 and 1.5, are allowed for <u>all</u> Assessment Areas, except Preparation, where students will be marked 0, 1, 1.5 or 2 depending on their pre-work completion and quality of work.)						
4	Demonstration of Technical Competences	The participant demonstrated the technical skills required for the Workshop activities.	Participant consistently demonstrated the knowledge on the technical content being covered during all Workshop activities.	Participant demonstrated a reasonable level of knowledge on the technical content being covered during most of the Workshop activities.	Participant demonstrated very little or no understanding of the technical content being covered during most of the Workshop activities.	1%

Individual contribution – Day 3 (2%) / Day 3 (4%) for Capstone Repeater Class

Assessment Area			Exceed (2 marks)	Meet (1 mark)	Below Standard (0 mark)	Weighting
(Interval marks, i.e. 0.5 and 1.5, are allowed, except Preparation, where students will be marked 0, 1, 1.5 or 2 depending on their pre-work completion and quality of work.)						
1	Preparation	The participant completed all Pework and was well prepared <u>before</u> the Workshop.	Participant completed all Pework assignments demonstrating the knowledge required.	Participant completed all Pework assignments.	Participant completed some or none of the Pework assignments.	2% or 4% (Repeater Class)

Team Presentation - Day 3 (8%) / Day 3 (16%) for Capstone Repeater Class

Assessment Area			Exceed (2 marks)	Meet (1 mark)	Below Standard (0 mark)	Assessed on Team basis/ Individual basis	Weighting
(Interval marks, i.e. 0.5 and 1.5, are allowed for <u>all</u> Assessment Areas, except Preparation, where students will be marked 0, 1, 1.5 or 2 depending on their pre-work completion and quality of work.)							
1	Participation	The participant actively engaged during the team preparation of the presentation.	Participant actively engaged during the preparation and team discussion for the team presentation with one another consistently.	Participant engaged during the preparation and team discussion for the team presentation with one another most of the time.	Participant took part in very few of the preparation for the presentation and was not engaged with one another.	Individual basis	2% or 4% (Repeaters Class)
2	Presentation skills	The participant demonstrated effective presentation skills that engages the audience.	Participant demonstrated confidence in delivering presentation.	Participant demonstrated clarity in delivering presentation.	Participant was unconfident in delivering presentation.	Individual basis	2% or 4% (Repeaters Class)
3	Organisation and Teamwork	The team demonstrated skills in managing and structuring a presentation that conveyed the intended message, and appropriately allocated presentation tasks among team members.	Team demonstrated strong organisation skills and allocated presentation tasks among team members evenly. The transition was smooth and natural, and team members helped each other as needed.	Team demonstrated fair organisation skills and fairly allocated presentation tasks among team members during the presentation.	Team demonstrated poor organisation skills and did not effectively allocate the presentation with significant domination by one or two members, and transition was poor.	Team basis	2% or 4% (Repeaters Class)

Assessment Area			Exceed (2 marks)	Meet (1 mark)	Below Standard (0 mark)	Assessed on Team basis/ Individual basis	Weighting
(Interval marks, i.e. 0.5 and 1.5, are allowed for <u>all</u> Assessment Areas, except Preparation, where students will be marked 0, 1, 1.5 or 2 depending on their pre-work completion and quality of work.)							
4	Visual Aid	The team had effectively use visual aid to support the presentation and to engage audience.	Team made use of visual aids effectively.	Team made use of visual aids in the presentation.	Team did not make use of visual aids.	Team basis	1% or 2% (Repeaters Class)
5	Handling Questions	The team was able to handle questions well during the Q&A session.	Team addressed questions asked during the Q&A session effectively.	Team addressed questions asked during the Q&A session.	Team failed to address questions asked during the Q&A session.	Team basis	1% or 2% (Repeaters Class)

Appendix B: Taxonomy

Level 1: Foundation

Skill	Verb	Definition
Knowledge The remembering of previously learned material (recall of facts)	Define	Give the accepted meaning of
	Identify	List or ascertaining possibilities before analysis; Point to the essential part or parts
	List	Provide a concise summary of the relevant points, often in bullet point format
	Outline	Give the main facts about something
	State	Accurately articulate established principles, concepts, terms etc.
Comprehension Demonstrative understanding of facts and ideas by organising, comparing, translating, interpreting, giving descriptions and stating main ideas	Describe	Communicate the key features of something, present a detailed account of something focusing on depth of knowledge
	Explain	Make clear the details of something; or show the reason for, or underlying cause of, or the means by which something occurs
	Illustrate	Offer examples, to show how something happens, that something happens, or make concrete a concept by giving examples
	Interpret	Make clear the meaning of something and its implications
	Summarise	Describe something concisely; bring together the main facts

Level 2: Intermediate

Skill	Verb	Definition
Application Using new knowledge. Solve problems to new situations by applying acquired knowledge, facts, techniques and rules in a different way	Account for/ Demonstrate	Give details of accounting entries to be made for (in the context of financial reporting or justify (if used in a more general context); Demonstrate the accounting treatment by using a set of accounts
	Apply	Demonstrate knowledge, concepts or techniques; Use established methods/ tools/ procedures to resolve relatively straightforward scenarios or problems
	Calculate/ Compute	Determine by computation or arrive at by mathematical means or processes
	Prepare	Follow established procedures/ methods to create a report of financial information or commentary (e.g. using a proforma spreadsheet)
	Solve	To work out to a result or conclusion
	Use	Apply in a practical way
Analysis Examine and break information into parts by identifying motives or causes. Make inferences and find evidence to support generalisation	Analyse	To examine methodically by separating into parts and studying the interrelationships in order to discover essential features
	Compare	Critically consider two or more things, emphasising their similarities
	Contrast	Critically consider two or more things, emphasising their differences
	Classify/ Categorize	Apply concepts to categorize information or groups into categories
	Justify	Explain the reason for recommendation made, or underlying cause of, based on an analysis of a range of available options
	Prioritise/ Determine	Determine the order for dealing with a series of items or tasks according to their relative importance e.g. Determine the priorities/ determine the level of importance

Level 3: Advanced

Skill	Verb	Definition
Integration Compile information together in a different way by combining elements in a new pattern or proposing alternative solutions	Construct	To form an idea, a process, or procedure by bringing together various theoretical and conceptual elements
	Design	Develop a procedure/ process or course of action based on selection of the optimum combination from a range of available options
	Develop	To bring something into existence that has not previously existed, or to reshape something from its initial position into something more refined; Use judgement to bring to a more advanced or effective state or to create a plan
	Formulate	Devise and put a plan into words
	Integrate	Combine one aspect of learning with another to form a holistic understanding of a process, procedure or course of action
	Plan/ Propose	Formulate a detailed proposal for doing or achieving something
	Produce	Draw together similar or disparate items to form a report containing financial and/ or non-financial information
Evaluation The ability to judge the value of material for a given purpose	Advise	Communicate appropriately the recommended course of action based on an analysis of specific circumstances in a manner suited to the recipient
	Appraise	Assess the value or quality of something; or to assess its performance
	Consider	Think carefully about something before making a decision, to look closely or attentively at something through a process involving critical thinking
	Evaluate	Assess and determine the value, importance or qualities of something, normally with reference to specific criteria and draw conclusions
	Recommend	Select the best course of action or choice; Advocate a particular outcome or course of action based on an analysis of a range of available options

Appendix C: Examination Regulations

It is your responsibility to understand and adhere at all times to the Examination Regulations. Failure to follow any of the general regulations and the specific regulation related to your enrolled module examinations, stated as below, may result in marks penalty, disqualification from the entire examination session, or even subject to sanctions under the disciplinary provisions of the Professional Accountants By-laws.

General Regulations to ALL Examinations

1. You are required to comply in all respects with any instructions issued by the Institute before an examination session or by the Examination Supervisor and/or his/her authorized invigilating personnel during an examination. An Examination Supervisor (or person so authorized) is obliged to report any cases of irregularity or improper conduct to the Institute and is empowered to discontinue the examination of a candidate suspected of any misconduct and request the candidate to leave the examination centre.
2. Any attempt to deceive the Institute or the Examination Supervisor by giving false or misleading information may result in further appropriate action.
3. You should not engage in any unprofessional conduct designed to assist you or any other person(s) in your examination attempt. You should not obtain, or attempt to obtain assistance by improper means from any other person.
4. You must print out and bring the Docket to gain admission to the examination centre assigned and must also make this available for scrutiny throughout the examination. You may not be permitted to sit your examination(s) if you fail to produce the Docket.
5. Except the content of the downloaded Docket, no other contents are allowed in the printout. You must not write anything on the Docket throughout the examination period.
6. **For examination location in Hong Kong**, you should take your valid identification document according to your student register in HKICPA to the examination centre. If you have registered your HKID with the Institute, bring it to the examination centre for identity verification. If you have not registered with HKID, bring your registered passport. Otherwise, bring your registered PRC ID. This identification document must be produced with the Docket at every examination for checking purpose. The name on your identification document must match exactly the name shown on the Docket. If you are unable to prove your identity, you may not be permitted to sit your examination(s).
7. **For examination location in Beijing/Guangzhou/Shanghai**, you should take your valid identification document according to your student register in HKICPA to the examination centre. If you have registered your PRC ID with the Institute, bring it to the examination centre for identity verification. If you have not registered with PRC ID, bring your registered passport. Otherwise, bring your registered HKID. This identification document must be produced with the Docket at every examination for checking purpose. The name on your identification document must match exactly the name shown on the Docket. If you are unable to prove your identity, you may not be permitted to sit your examination(s).

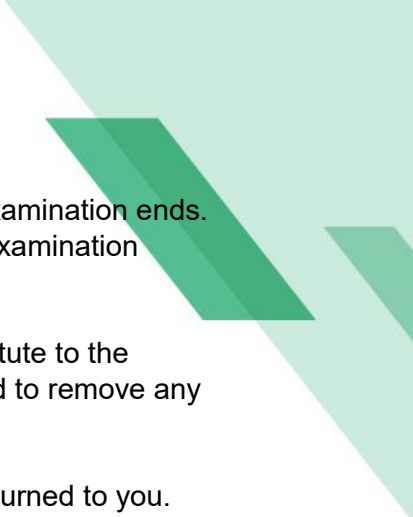
8. Electronic dictionaries of any size or models are not allowed. Other than computer-based examination which required you to bring your own computer devices ("BYOD") to the examinations, computers of any size or models are not allowed to be brought to the examination centre.
9. All permitted items must not be equipped with communication function.
10. Candidates must not use, wear or keep accessible during an examination any unauthorized electronic communication or smart devices:
 - a) Any such device, if brought into the examination venue, must be completely switched off throughout the examination and be placed inside a closed bag under your chair, on the floor beneath your desk, or other location as directed and must not be accessed during the examination.
 - b) Electronic communication or smart devices include, without limitation, mobile phones, smart watches, smart glasses, tablets, wireless earphones, fitness tracker, recording or storage devices, and any similar or future technology capable of communication, recording, storage, or with internet connectivity.
 - c) Should any electronic device emit a sound or signal, or vibrates during the examination, you may be asked to hand over such device to the relevant authorized personnel for keeping until the conclusion of the examination, and after the examination, you will be asked to show any communication / viewing logs or any stored information / images held in such device (if any). Such incident will also be reported to the Institute for further investigation.
 - d) Unless you have prior permission from the Examination Supervisor and/or his/her authorized invigilating personnel, you are not allowed to access the contents of your bag containing your electronic or smart device.
11. Any violation of clause 10 above may result, among others, in disqualification from the entire examination session and/or subject to disciplinary action and sanctions pursuant to the Professional Accountants By-laws.
12. You are not allowed to take photographs, audio records or video records inside the examination centre at all times. Any photographs or recordings taken must be surrendered to the Examination Supervisor for immediate disposal or deletion. Such incident will be reported to the Institute for further investigation.
13. You are also not allowed to display photographs, audio records or video records taken inside the examination centre electronically or publicly. Such incident will also be reported to the Institute for further investigation.
14. You should leave your personal belongings in the examination centre according to the instruction by the Examination Supervisor. The Institute or the examination administration service provider will not under any circumstances accept responsibility for loss, theft or damage to articles deposited in the examination centre.

15. You must not behave in a manner likely to distract other candidates. You must not disturb, speak or give signals to other candidates during the examination.
16. Your examination result will normally be available online within 10 - 12 weeks after the examination. You can check your result by logging in to the Student Centre on the result release date. The date will be shown in the examination timetable section of the website. The Institute will not enter into correspondence or deal with telephone enquiries on examination results.
17. The Institute has endeavoured to ensure you to sit your examinations in the best conditions. If you find any undesirable conditions at your examination centre (e.g. insufficient lighting, noise disturbance, dripping water etc.), you should seek help from invigilation personnel/ Examination Supervisor at once. Subsequent complaints of performance being affected by undesirable centre conditions after the examination will NOT be entertained.

(A) Examination Regulations applicable to Associate Module Examinations

1. You are authorized to sit only those examination(s) indicated at the examination centre(s) shown on the Examination Attendance Docket ("Docket"). Seat number will be assigned upon you arrive at the examination centre.
2. For Associate Level Modules 1 to 9 Examination in Hong Kong and Modules 1 to 10 in Guangzhou/Shanghai, you should arrive at least 45 minutes before your examination starts. The Examination Supervisor will not allow you to enter the examination centre after the first 30 minutes of the examination.
3. For Associate Level Module 10 Examination in Hong Kong, you should arrive at least 1 hour before your examination starts. The Examination Supervisor will not allow you to enter the examination centre after the first 30 minutes of the examination.
4. For Associate Level Modules 1 to 9 Examination, the examinations are closed-book examinations. You are not permitted to take to your desk, use or possess while at your desk, any books, notes or other materials. You are reminded to check all stationery brought to the examination centre must not contain any unauthorised materials.
5. For Associate Level Modules 1 to 9 Examination, scratch paper will be provided at the examination centre. You are advised to bring your own pen for doing the rough work. The work done on the scratch paper will not be marked. Scratch paper will be collected at the end of the examination.
6. For Associate Level Module 10 Examination, the examination is an open-book examination. You are permitted to take into the examination centre your own notes, reference books in **hard copy format** and your own stationery.
7. Associate Modules 1 to 9 Examination in Hong Kong and Modules 1 to 10 in Guangzhou/Shanghai will be conducted in an equipped examination centre.
8. For attending **Associate Level Module 10 Examination in Hong Kong, you must bring your own testing device ("BYOD") to the examination venue.** Your device must comply with the BYOD specifications: (1) Wi-Fi network compatible, (2) CPU: Dual-core or above, (3) Memory: 8 GB or above, (4) Display: 1024 x 768 or above, (5) Hard Drive: 10 GB or above, (6) Operating System: Windows 10 or above / Mac OS 14 or above, (7) Browser Requirements: Google Chrome 90 or above / Safari 13 or above / Edge 90 or above, (8) User Account: Administrator privileges recommended, (9) iPad or Android Tablets are NOT allowed.
 - (i) Your device should be fully charged, and be able to hold a charge for 4 hours or more. In addition, your testing device must meet the requirements listed above.
 - (ii) You should bring your own portable power bank to ensure your examination runs smoothly. Any performance potentially affected by limited power supply issue will NOT be entertained.
 - (iii) You should install the latest version of the examination application "HKEAA Cloud Exam Client" correctly on your device designated for the BYOD examination prior to the examination. You are recommended to check for the latest updates 2 days prior to the examination.

- (iv) You should disable or terminate all writing assistants, messaging apps, VPNs, AI application and other unauthorised application on your testing device.
 - (v) You will not be permitted to borrow devices from other candidates or from examination centre on examination day.
 - (vi) If your device fails to meet the above required standards or experiences battery issues during the exam, you will bear full responsibility, includes losing examination time and/ or being unable to participate in the examination. No refunds or retests will be granted under these circumstances.
 - (vii) If any technical issue related to your device remains unresolved and prevents you from joining the examination, the invigilator has the right to ask you to leave the examination centre.
 - (viii) The following items are prohibited at the examination: laptop stand(s), all stylus pens, smart pens, and other electronic writing instruments, separate computer monitors, separate keyboard and detachable privacy screens, external storage devices (e.g. USB, hard drive).
9. You can use a calculator which should be battery-powered, noiseless, cordless, pocket-sized WITHOUT communication function, printout, dictionary or graphic/ word display facilities.
 10. Before the examination begins, you should enter your candidate number and the first four letters of your registered identification document according to the instruction by the Examination Supervisor.
 11. You must check the “Personal Information” page in the examination system to ensure that you have been issued with the correct question paper.
 12. The examination will start automatically at the examination start time. You are allowed to attempt the questions on the examination platform at the commencement of the examination.
 13. The examination duration for Associate Modules 1 to 5 Examination is 1 hour 45 minutes, Modules 6 to 9 Examination is 2 hour 30 minutes, and Module 10 is 3 hours.
 14. You are not allowed to leave the examination centre during the first 30 minutes.
 15. If you wish to end your examination and leave the examination centre before the examination end time, You should raise your hand to notify the invigilator first. Once you click the “End Exam and Submit” button, the examination CANNOT be resumed.
 16. For Associate Level Modules 6 to 10 Examination, you must answer in English.
 17. For Associate Level Modules 10 Examination, you should enter your answers of the questions and/ or sub-parts of the questions in the designated answer areas. Any answers entered in the wrong designated answer area will score no mark.
 18. Your name or personal information MUST NOT appear anywhere in your answer.

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19. You must stop operating the computer/ writing immediately when the examination ends. You are not allowed to leave your seat until instructed to do so by the Examination Supervisor.
 20. You must submit all scratch paper and any materials owned by the Institute to the invigilation personnel at the end of the examination. You are not allowed to remove any items owned by the Institute from the examination centre.
 21. All scratch paper remains the property of the Institute and will not be returned to you.

(B) Examination Regulations applicable to Professional Module Examinations

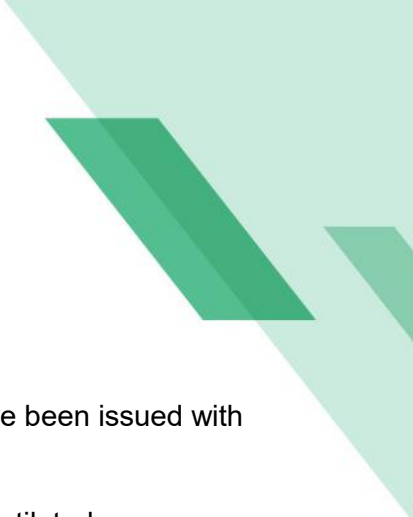
1. You are authorized to sit only those examination(s) indicated at the examination centre(s) and desk(s) shown on the Examination Attendance Docket ("Docket").
2. You should arrive at least 45 minutes before your examination starts. The Examination Supervisor will not allow you to enter the examination centre after the first 30 minutes of the examination.
3. The examination is an open-book examination. You are permitted to take into the examination centre your own notes, reference books and stationery (including but not limited to noiseless and cordless programmable calculators). Computers and electronic dictionaries of any size or models are not allowed. All permitted items must not be equipped with communication function.
4. For examinations in Beijing/Guangzhou/Shanghai, you are not allowed to wear all kinds of wristwatches (including analogue watches, digital wristwatches and smartwatches) during the examination. You should leave your watches with your personal belongings.
5. You are not allowed to leave the examination centre during the first 30 minutes or the last 15 minutes of the examination.
6. The examination lasts for 3 hours. You are allowed to write your answers on the script booklet immediately at the commencement of the examination when instructed to do so by the Examination Supervisor.
7. You must answer in English. You must write your answer legibly in black or blue ink.
8. You should write clearly the question numbers and/or parts before your answers or at the top of the page of the script booklet.
9. Before the examination begins, you should complete all the details on the front cover of your script booklets according to the instruction by the Examination Supervisor. Your name or personal information **MUST NOT** appear anywhere on your script booklet. You should also complete the details on any continuation script booklet which may be given to you during the examination. No extra time is allowed for writing this at the end of the examination.
10. You must check the front cover of the question paper to ensure that you have been issued with the correct question paper.
11. **YOU MUST USE THE APPROPRIATE SCRIPT BOOKLET TO ANSWER EACH SECTION OF THE QUESTION PAPER**, i.e. Case on the script booklet for Case and Essay/ Short Questions on the script booklet for Essay/ Short Questions.
12. The script booklets and question paper must not be torn off, unstitched or mutilated.
13. You must stop writing immediately once the end of examination is announced. You are not allowed to leave your desk until instructed to do so by the Examination Supervisor.
14. You must submit all script booklets, question paper and any materials owned by the Institute to the invigilation personnel at the end of the examination. Any materials

submitted other than the script booklet provided will not be marked. You are not allowed to remove any items owned by the Institute from the examination centre.

15. All script booklets and question paper remain the property of the Institute and will not be returned to you.

(C) Examination Regulations applicable to Capstone Final Examination

1. You are authorized to sit only those examination(s) indicated at the examination centre(s) and desk(s) shown on the Examination Attendance Docket ("Docket").
2. You should arrive at least 45 minutes before your examination starts. The Examination Supervisor will not allow you to enter the examination centre after the first 30 minutes of the examination.
3. The examination is an open-book examination. You are permitted to take into the examination centre your own notes, reference books and stationery (including but not limited to noiseless and cordless programmable calculators). Computers and electronic dictionaries of any size or models are not allowed. All permitted items must not be equipped with communication function.
4. Pre-seen materials are available online five business days in advance for candidates to prepare for the examination. You must print and bring these materials with you to the examination centre on the examination day. No spare copies will be provided in the examination centre. You are not allowed to use artificial intelligence ("AI") tools to access, analyze, or replicate exam-related content of the pre-seen materials as this would breach the confidentiality of the examination contents. Copying and paraphrasing sections of AI-generated content and submitted for assessment is not considered as your own works. Any violation may result in marks penalty or even disqualification from the entire examination.
5. For examinations in Beijing/Guangzhou/Shanghai, you are not allowed to wear all kinds of wristwatches (including analogue watches, digital wristwatches and smartwatches) during the examination. You should leave your watches with your personal belongings.
6. You are not allowed to leave the examination centre during the first 30 minutes or the last 15 minutes of the examination.
7. The examination lasts for 4 hours. You are allowed to write your answers on the script booklet immediately at the commencement of the examination when instructed to do so by the Examination Supervisor.
8. You must answer in English. You must write your answer legibly in black or blue ink.
9. **YOU MUST USE SEPERATE SCRIPT BOOKLETS TO ANSWER EACH QUESTION.** Question numbers should be circled on the cover of script booklets.
10. You should write clearly the question numbers before your answers or at the top of the page of the script booklet.
11. Before the examination begins, you should complete all the details on the front cover of your script booklets according to the instruction by the Examination Supervisor. Your name or personal information **MUST NOT** appear anywhere on your script booklet. You should also complete the details on any continuation script booklet which may be given to you during the examination. No extra time is allowed for writing this at the end of the examination.

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12. You must check the front cover of the question paper to ensure that you have been issued with the correct question paper.
 13. The script booklets and question paper must not be torn off, unstitched or mutilated.
 14. You must stop writing immediately once the end of examination is announced. You are not allowed to leave your desk until instructed to do so by the Examination Supervisor.
 15. You must submit all script booklets, question paper and any materials owned by the Institute to the invigilation personnel at the end of the examination. Any materials submitted other than the script booklet provided will not be marked. You are not allowed to remove any items owned by the Institute from the examination centre.
 16. All script booklets and question paper remain the property of the Institute and will not be returned to you.

Appendix D: Extract of the Professional Accountants By-laws

The following are extracts from the Professional Accountants By-laws which should be observed by all registered students of the Institute -

By-law 32: Registration

- (1) Registration of a person as a registered student shall -
 - (a) remain in force until the 1st day of January in the year following the year in which he was so registered; and
 - (b) be renewable annually not later than the 31st day of January in each year.
- (2) A registered student shall sign an undertaking, in the specified form, to abide by such of these by-laws as are applicable to him.

By-law 33: Register

- (1) The Registrar shall keep a register of registered students and shall advise the Council of the name of a registered student whose annual registration fee or other fee or money due to the Institute is more than 2 months in arrear.
- (2) The Council may direct the Registrar to remove from the register of registered students the name of a student whose annual registration fee or other fee or money due to the Institute is more than three months in arrear.
- (3) The Registrar shall in writing notify a student of a direction of the Council under paragraph (2), and if the annual registration fee or other fee or money due to the Institute remains unpaid for more than 14 days after such notice the Registrar shall remove the name of the student from the register.

By-law 34: Disciplinary Provisions

- (1) A complaint that a registered student -
 - (a) has been convicted of an offence under Part V (Perjury) of the Crimes Ordinance;
 - (b) has been convicted in Hong Kong or elsewhere of any offence involving dishonesty;
 - (c) has been guilty of misconduct in carrying out his duties;
 - (d) has been guilty of conduct which renders him unfit to become a certified public accountant; or
 - (e) has refused, or neglected without reasonable excuse, to comply with such of these by-laws as are applicable to him,

shall be made to the Registrar who shall submit the complaint to the Council which may, in its discretion, constitute a Student Disciplinary Committee to deal with the complaint.

- (1A) If the Council decides not to constitute a Student Disciplinary Committee to deal with the complaint, the complainant who is aggrieved by the Council's decision may request the Council to constitute a Student Disciplinary Committee to deal with the complaint, whereupon the Council shall, unless it is of the opinion that no prima facie case has been shown for the complaint, or that the complaint is frivolous or vexatious, constitute a Student Disciplinary Committee to deal with the complaint.
- (2) Where the Registrar has reason to believe that paragraph (1) applies to a registered student, he shall submit the facts to the Council which may, in its discretion, constitute a Student Disciplinary Committee to deal with the complaint.
- (3) Every hearing of the Student Disciplinary Committee shall be held in public unless the Student Disciplinary Committee -
 - (a) on its own motion; or
 - (b) on the application of -
 - (i) the complainant; or
 - (ii) the registered student against whom the complaint is made,

determines that in the interests of justice a hearing or any part thereof shall not be held in public in which case it may hold the hearing or the part thereof (as the case may be) in private.

By-law 35: Powers of Student Disciplinary Committee

- (1) If, after due inquiry, a Student Disciplinary Committee is satisfied that a complaint under by-law 34 is proved the Student Disciplinary Committee may, in its discretion, make any one or more of the following orders against the registered student -
 - (i) that he be declared unfit to remain a registered student, and that the Registrar remove his name from the register of registered students;
 - (ii) that he be declared ineligible for such period (not exceeding 2 years) to sit for such examinations of the Institute as shall be specified in the order;
 - (iii) that he be reprimanded;
 - (iv) that he be admonished,

and may in an order under sub-paragraph (i) or (ii) provide for the order to take effect on or from such date as the Student Disciplinary Committee thinks fit and may in any case make such order as the Student Disciplinary Committee thinks fit with regard to the payment of costs and expenses of and incidental to the proceedings, whether of the Institute (including the fees and expenses of the Student Disciplinary Committee) or of any complainant or of the registered student, and any costs and expenses ordered to be paid may be recovered as a civil debt.

- (1A) In addition, the Student Disciplinary Committee may in any case provide for an order to take effect only upon the happening or non-happening of such event within such period as may be specified by the Student Disciplinary Committee.
- (2) The Registrar shall cause a copy of an order made under this by-law to be served forthwith upon the registered student concerned and shall forward a copy to the Council.
- (3) For the purposes of an inquiry under this by-law the Student Disciplinary Committee has the following powers
 - (a) to take evidence on oath;
 - (b) to summon a person to attend the proceedings to give evidence or produce a document or any other thing in the person's possession, and to examine the person as a witness;
 - (c) to award to a witness the expenses that, in the opinion of the Student Disciplinary Committee, the witness has incurred by reason of attendance.

By-law 35B: Consent Order

- (1) Where a complaint that by-law 34(1)(c) or (e) applies to a registered student is referred to the Student Disciplinary Committee and the Student Disciplinary Committee, without hearing either the complainant or the registered student, is of the view that the complaint is of such a nature that if the complaint is proved, the appropriate order or orders to be made should fall within one or more of the following orders under by-law 35 -
 - (a) an order that the registered student be reprimanded;
 - (b) an order that the registered student be admonished;
 - (c) an order that the registered student pay the costs and expenses of and incidental to the proceedings, whether of the Institute (including the costs and expenses of the Student Disciplinary Committee) or of the complainant,

the Student Disciplinary Committee may give notice to the complainant and the registered student.

- (2) A notice given by the Student Disciplinary Committee under paragraph (1) shall state
 - (a) the order or orders, being order or orders no more than those referred to in paragraph (1), which the Student Disciplinary Committee proposes to make if the registered student admits to the complaint; and
 - (b) the time (being not earlier than 14 days from the date when the notice was given, or such further time as the Student Disciplinary Committee may allow) within which each of the complainant and the registered student is required to inform the Student Disciplinary Committee as to whether he will consent to the proposed order or orders.
- (3) If the complainant and the registered student consent to the proposed order or orders the Student Disciplinary Committee shall make an order or orders in terms of the proposed order

or orders and such order and orders shall be deemed to be an order or orders made under by-law 35 save that by-law 36(1) shall not apply to such order or orders.

- (4) If the complainant or the registered student informs the Student Disciplinary Committee that he does not consent to the proposed order or orders, or if the Student Disciplinary Committee considers that the consent of either the complainant or the registered student is not forthcoming notwithstanding the notice under paragraph (2)(b), the Student Disciplinary Committee shall inform the Council and the following shall apply -
 - (a) the Student Disciplinary Committee shall be dissolved;
 - (b) the Council shall constitute a new Student Disciplinary Committee to deal with the complaint with which the dissolved committee was concerned by directing the Student Disciplinary Committee Convenor to appoint the chairman and other members of the new Student Disciplinary Committee;
 - (c) a person who was a member of the dissolved committee shall not be eligible for membership of the new Student Disciplinary Committee; and
 - (d) the new Student Disciplinary Committee shall deal with the complaint afresh without regard to this by-law and, accordingly, it shall not have any regard to any proceedings of the dissolved committee, including the proposed order or orders of the dissolved committee or any failure or refusal of the complainant or the registered student to consent to the proposed order or orders.

By-law 36: Appeal to Council

- (1) A registered student aggrieved by an order made under by-law 35 may, within 21 days of the date of service upon him of the order, appeal to the Council.
- (2) The practice and procedure on an appeal to the Council shall be such as the Council may determine.
- (3) On an appeal the Council may -
 - (a) affirm or vary the order;
 - (b) rescind the order and substitute any other order which might have been made by the Student Disciplinary Committee under by-law 35.
- (4) The Registrar shall notify the registered student concerned of the decision of the Council.

By-law 36A: Conduct of Proceedings and Representation

At the hearing of a complaint, a registered student whose conduct is the subject of such proceedings shall be entitled to be represented by counsel or a solicitor, or, with the approval of the Student

Disciplinary Committee, by some other person appointed by the registered student to represent him throughout the proceedings.

By-law 38: Restriction on taking Examinations

- (1) Subject to paragraphs (2), (3), (4) and (5), a person is not entitled to enter for an examination of the Institute unless he -
 - (a) is a registered student; or
 - (b) is a person required or permitted to sit an examination under or pursuant to -
 - (i) any of the provisions of the Ordinance and the AFRC Ordinance; or
 - (ii) any agreement of mutual or reciprocal recognition between another accountancy body and the Institute.
- (2) Subject to paragraphs (3) and (4), a registered student is not entitled to enter for an examination of the Institute unless he -
 - (a) has paid his annual registration fee to the Institute for the year in which the examination is held; and
 - (b) complies with such regulations relating to the examination as the Council may specify.
- (3) A registered student whose application for registration is made before 1 January 1999 is not entitled to enter for the examination known as the "HKSA professional programme and examinations" held between 1 January 1999 and 31 December 2001.
- (4) A registered student whose application for registration is made before 1 January 1999 is not entitled to enter for the "HKSA or HKICPA professional programme and examinations" held on or after 1 January 2002 unless, in addition to complying with paragraph 2(a) and (b), he -
 - (a) holds a degree in accountancy awarded by an educational institute approved by the Council; or
 - (b) has completed a study programme approved by the Council.
- (5) A person is not entitled to enter for an examination of the Institute unless he complies with such regulations relating to the examination as the Council may specify".

By-law 39: Removal from Register

- (1) Subject to paragraph (2), the Registrar shall remove from the register the name of any registered student who -
 - (a) has not presented himself for any of the examinations of the Institute within 5 years from the date of his registration as a registered student; or

- (b) has not passed the final section of the examinations of the Institute within 10 years from the date of his registration as a registered student.
- (2) The Council may extend the period of time specified in paragraph (1)(a) or (b) in any particular case.

By-law 41: Restriction on Registration as a Certified Public Accountant

- (1) Subject to paragraph (2), neither a registered student who passes the examinations of the Institute nor a member of an accountancy body accepted by the Council under section 24(1A) shall be registered as a certified public accountant unless he has not less than 5 years practical experience.
- (2) The Council may, in the case of
 - (a) the holder of a degree awarded by an educational institute approved by the Council;
 - (b) the holder of a diploma in accountancy awarded by an educational institute approved by the Council who has attended a full time course for not less than 3 years; or
 - (c) a registered student who passes an entry examination approved by the Council and the "HKSA or HKICPA professional programme and examinations" held on or after 1 January 1999,reduce the period of practical experience required by paragraph (1) by such amount as it thinks fit, not being more than 2 years.
- (3) In this by-law -

"practical experience" means experience whether in Hong Kong or elsewhere acceptable to the Council as an employee of a person practising public accountancy or in the financial or management accountancy department of an organisation in industry, commerce or the public service or in a similar department.